

[MS-PCQ]:

Performance Counter Query Protocol

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Table of Contents

1	Introduction	7
1.1	Glossary	7
1.2	References	8
1.2.1	Normative References	8
1.2.2	Informative References	9
1.3	Overview	9
1.4	Relationship to Other Protocols	9
1.5	Prerequisites/Preconditions	9
1.6	Applicability Statement	9
1.7	Versioning and Capability Negotiation	10
1.8	Vendor-Extensible Fields	10
1.9	Standards Assignments.....	10
2	Messages.....	11
2.1	Transport	11
2.2	Common Data Types	11
2.2.1	RPC_HQUERY	11
2.2.2	PRPC_HQUERY	11
2.2.3	error_status_t.....	12
2.2.4	Structures	12
2.2.4.1	_PERF_COUNTERSET_REG_INFO	12
2.2.4.2	_PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO.....	13
2.2.4.3	_STRING_BUFFER_HEADER.....	19
2.2.4.4	_STRING_COUNTER_HEADER.....	19
2.2.4.5	_PERF_INSTANCE_HEADER.....	20
2.2.4.6	_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER.....	20
2.2.4.7	_PERF_DATA_HEADER.....	21
2.2.4.8	_PERF_COUNTER_HEADER.....	21
2.2.4.9	_PERF_COUNTER_DATA.....	22
2.2.4.10	_PERF_MULTI_INSTANCES.....	22
2.2.4.11	_PERF_MULTI_COUNTERS.....	22
3	Protocol Details.....	24
3.1	Server Details.....	24
3.1.1	Abstract Data Model.....	24
3.1.1.1	Countersets.....	24
3.1.1.2	Counterset Instances.....	24
3.1.1.3	Counters.....	24
3.1.1.4	Providers	24
3.1.1.5	Query Handles.....	25
3.1.2	Timers	25
3.1.3	Initialization.....	25
3.1.4	Message Processing Events and Sequencing Rules	25
3.1.4.1	PerflibV2 Interface	26
3.1.4.1.1	PerflibV2EnumerateCounterSet (Opnum 0)	26
3.1.4.1.2	PerflibV2QueryCounterSetRegistrationInfo (Opnum 1)	27
3.1.4.1.3	PerflibV2EnumerateCounterSetInstances (Opnum 2).....	33
3.1.4.1.4	PerflibV2OpenQueryHandle (Opnum 3).....	35
3.1.4.1.5	PerflibV2QueryCounterInfo (Opnum 5).....	35
3.1.4.1.6	PerflibV2QueryCounterData (Opnum 6).....	37
3.1.4.1.7	PerflibV2ValidateCounters (Opnum 7)	44
3.1.4.1.8	PerflibV2CloseQueryHandle (Opnum 4)	46
3.1.5	Timer Events.....	46
3.1.6	Other Local Events.....	46
3.2	Client Details.....	47

3.2.1	Abstract Data Model.....	47
3.2.2	Timers	47
3.2.3	Initialization.....	47
3.2.4	Message Processing Events and Sequencing Rules	47
3.2.5	Timer Events.....	48
3.2.6	Other Local Events.....	48
4	Protocol Examples.....	49
4.1	Querying for Performance Counter Data.....	49
5	Security.....	51
5.1	Security Considerations for Implementers	51
5.2	Index of Security Parameters	51
6	Appendix A: Full IDL.....	52
7	Appendix B: Product Behavior	54
8	Change Tracking.....	56
9	Index.....	57

1 Introduction

The Performance Counter Query Protocol is a **remote procedure call** (RPC)–based protocol that is used for browsing **performance counters** and retrieving performance counter values from a server.

Sections 1.5, 1.8, 1.9, 2, and 3 of this specification are normative. All other sections and examples in this specification are informative.

1.1 Glossary

This document uses the following terms:

Authentication Service (AS): A service that issues ticket granting tickets (TGTs), which are used for authenticating principals within the realm or domain served by the **Authentication Service**.

counterset: A logical entity consisting of a group of related **performance counters**. For more information, see [\[MSDN-COUNT\]](#).

globally unique identifier (GUID): A term used interchangeably with **universally unique identifier (UUID)** in Microsoft protocol technical documents (TDs). Interchanging the usage of these terms does not imply or require a specific algorithm or mechanism to generate the value. Specifically, the use of this term does not imply or require that the algorithms described in [\[RFC4122\]](#) or [\[C706\]](#) have to be used for generating the GUID. See also universally unique identifier (UUID).

Interface Definition Language (IDL): The International Standards Organization (ISO) standard language for specifying the interface for remote procedure calls. For more information, see [\[C706\]](#) section 4.

Network Data Representation (NDR): A specification that defines a mapping from **Interface Definition Language (IDL)** data types onto octet streams. **NDR** also refers to the runtime environment that implements the mapping facilities (for example, data provided to **NDR**). For more information, see [\[MS-RPCE\]](#) and [\[C706\]](#) section 14.

performance counter: A numeric measurement of the performance of one or more computing resources. Bandwidth, Throughputs, and Availability are examples of **performance counters**.

Performance Log Users Group: A set of users that have permission granted by the system administrator to collect **performance counter** information.

Performance Monitor Users Group: A set of users that have permission granted by the system administrator to collect performance counter information.

provider: A logical entity that updates the **performance counter** values. For more information, see [\[MSDN-COUNT\]](#).

remote procedure call (RPC): A communication protocol used primarily between client and server. The term has three definitions that are often used interchangeably: a runtime environment providing for communication facilities between computers (the RPC runtime); a set of request-and-response message exchanges between computers (the RPC exchange); and the single message from an RPC exchange (the RPC message). For more information, see [\[C706\]](#).

RPC protocol sequence: A character string that represents a valid combination of a **remote procedure call (RPC)** protocol, a network layer protocol, and a transport layer protocol, as described in [\[C706\]](#) and [\[MS-RPCE\]](#).

RPC transport: The underlying network services used by the remote procedure call (RPC) runtime for communications between network nodes. For more information, see [\[C706\]](#) section 2.

system performance time: A timer that is updated at a hardware-dependent frequency. It has a higher-resolution (more accurate) than **system time**.

system time: Coordinated universal time (UTC) with a resolution in milliseconds.

Unicode: A character encoding standard developed by the Unicode Consortium that represents almost all of the written languages of the world. The **Unicode** standard [UNICODE5.0.0/20071](#) provides three forms (UTF-8, UTF-16, and UTF-32) and seven schemes (UTF-8, UTF-16, UTF-16 BE, UTF-16 LE, UTF-32, UTF-32 LE, and UTF-32 BE).

Unicode string: A **Unicode** 8-bit string is an ordered sequence of 8-bit units, a **Unicode** 16-bit string is an ordered sequence of 16-bit code units, and a **Unicode** 32-bit string is an ordered sequence of 32-bit code units. In some cases, it could be acceptable not to terminate with a terminating null character. Unless otherwise specified, all **Unicode strings** follow the UTF-16LE encoding scheme with no Byte Order Mark (BOM).

universally unique identifier (UUID): A 128-bit value. UUIDs can be used for multiple purposes, from tagging objects with an extremely short lifetime, to reliably identifying very persistent objects in cross-process communication such as client and server interfaces, manager entry-point vectors, and **RPC** objects. UUIDs are highly likely to be unique. UUIDs are also known as **globally unique identifiers (GUIDs)** and these terms are used interchangeably in the Microsoft protocol technical documents (TDs). Interchanging the usage of these terms does not imply or require a specific algorithm or mechanism to generate the UUID. Specifically, the use of this term does not imply or require that the algorithms described in [RFC4122] or [C706] has to be used for generating the UUID.

well-known endpoint: A preassigned, network-specific, stable address for a particular client/server instance. For more information, see [C706].

MAY, SHOULD, MUST, SHOULD NOT, MUST NOT: These terms (in all caps) are used as defined in [\[RFC2119\]](#). All statements of optional behavior use either MAY, SHOULD, or SHOULD NOT.

1.2 References

Links to a document in the Microsoft Open Specifications library point to the correct section in the most recently published version of the referenced document. However, because individual documents in the library are not updated at the same time, the section numbers in the documents may not match. You can confirm the correct section numbering by checking the [Errata](#).

1.2.1 Normative References

We conduct frequent surveys of the normative references to assure their continued availability. If you have any issue with finding a normative reference, please contact dochelp@microsoft.com. We will assist you in finding the relevant information.

[C706] The Open Group, "DCE 1.1: Remote Procedure Call", C706, August 1997, <https://publications.opengroup.org/c706>

Note Registration is required to download the document.

[MS-DTYP] Microsoft Corporation, "[Windows Data Types](#)".

[MS-ERREF] Microsoft Corporation, "[Windows Error Codes](#)".

[MS-LCID] Microsoft Corporation, "[Windows Language Code Identifier \(LCID\) Reference](#)".

[MS-RPCE] Microsoft Corporation, "[Remote Procedure Call Protocol Extensions](#)".

[RFC2119] Bradner, S., "Key words for use in RFCs to Indicate Requirement Levels", BCP 14, RFC 2119, March 1997, <https://www.rfc-editor.org/info/rfc2119>

1.2.2 Informative References

[MSDN-AUTHLEV] Microsoft Corporation, "RPC_C_AUTHN_LEVEL_xxx", <http://msdn.microsoft.com/en-us/library/ms678435.aspx>

[MSDN-COUNT] Microsoft Corporation, "Performance Counters", <http://msdn.microsoft.com/en-us/library/aa373083.aspx>

[MSDN-IMPLVL] Microsoft Corporation, "RPC_C_IMP_LEVEL_xxx", <http://msdn.microsoft.com/en-us/library/ms693790.aspx>

[MSFT-COUNTERTYPES] Microsoft Corporation, "Counter Types", March 2003, <http://technet2.microsoft.com/WindowsServer/en/library/2c455a3c-6964-432b-9402-40f439b980881033.mspx>

[PIPE] Microsoft Corporation, "Named Pipes", <http://msdn.microsoft.com/en-us/library/aa365590.aspx>

1.3 Overview

To effectively manage systems, administrators need the capability to query for **performance counter** data on the health or state of a particular application or system. Software components that are designed with performance counters are therefore easier to manage and diagnose. The Performance Counter Query Protocol enables system administrators to query performance counters on a remote server.

The Performance Counter Query Protocol is used to retrieve performance counter information from a server. The protocol allows a client to enumerate the performance counters that are available on the server. The server can use the protocol to return performance counter information, such as localized counter names and description strings, performance counter types (for more information, see [\[MSDN-COUNT\]](#)), and instance information if there are multiple instances of a performance counter. The client can also use the protocol to establish a query on the server and add or remove performance counters to it. The client can then repeatedly retrieve performance counter data that is associated with the query by using the protocol.

1.4 Relationship to Other Protocols

The Performance Counter Query Protocol relies on **RPC** for its transport. The Performance Counter Query Protocol is not used by any other protocol.

1.5 Prerequisites/Preconditions

The Performance Counter Query Protocol is implemented over **RPC**, and therefore has those prerequisites that are specified in [\[MS-RPCE\]](#) and that are common to RPC interfaces.

It is assumed that a client has obtained the name or IP address of the server that supports the Performance Counter Query Protocol before invoking the Performance Counter Query Protocol. The protocol also assumes that the client has sufficient security privileges to access files on the server.

1.6 Applicability Statement

The Performance Counter Query Protocol is appropriate for querying performance library 2.0-based counter **providers** and their counter data on a server.

1.7 Versioning and Capability Negotiation

This document addresses versioning issues in security and authentication methods (as specified in section [2.1](#) and [\[MS-RPCE\]](#)).

1.8 Vendor-Extensible Fields

The Performance Counter Query Protocol uses Win32 error codes. These values are taken from the Windows error number space that is specified in [\[MS-ERREF\]](#) section 2.2. Vendors SHOULD reuse those values with their indicated meaning because choosing any other value risks a collision in the future.

1.9 Standards Assignments

Parameter	Value	Reference
RPC interface UUID	da5a86c5-12c2-4943-ab30-7f74a813d853	[C706]
Well-known endpoint	\PIPE\winreg	[PIPE]

2 Messages

This section specifies common data types and how Performance Counter Query Protocol messages are encapsulated on the wire.

2.1 Transport

The Performance Counter Query Protocol uses the ncacn_np **RPC protocol sequence**.

The Performance Counter Query Protocol uses an **RPC well-known endpoint**. The well-known endpoint is a pipe name (for more information, see [\[PIPE\]](#)):

- \PIPE\winreg

The Performance Counter Query Protocol uses security information, as specified in [\[MS-RPCE\]](#) section 2.2.1.1.7. The client **MUST** specify the RPC **Authentication Service (AS)** as SPNEGO or NTLM.

The client **MUST** use an AS that encrypts all data being transferred to or from the RPC and ensures that the data is from the expected server and has not been modified.

The server **MUST** perform operations specified by the Performance Counter Query Protocol only if the AS being used encrypts all data being transferred to and from the procedure call and allows the server to perform on the client's behalf. [<1>](#) For more information on how the AS encrypts data, see [\[MSDN-AUTHLEV\]](#).

2.2 Common Data Types

The Performance Counter Query Protocol **MUST** indicate to the **RPC** runtime that it is to support the **Network Data Representation (NDR)** transfer syntax only, as specified in [\[C706\]](#) part 4.

In addition to RPC base types and definitions, as specified in [\[C706\]](#) and [\[MS-RPCE\]](#), additional data types are defined in the following sections, [2.2.1](#) through [2.2.3](#).

2.2.1 RPC_HQUERY

This type is declared as follows:

```
typedef [context_handle] HANDLE RPC_HQUERY;
```

RPC_HQUERY is a context handle used to maintain information about the **performance counters** that are being queried from the server by the client. The handle is returned by the server when the client initiates communication to query for performance counter data. The client then adds performance counters to a query list, maintained on the server, using the returned handle. When the client queries for the values of the performance counters, the server determines which performance counters to query based on the handle the client passes to the query method. The client closes the handle upon completion of the performance counter query, allowing the server to free the appropriate resources.

2.2.2 PRPC_HQUERY

This type is declared as follows:

```
typedef RPC_HQUERY* PRPC_HQUERY;
```

PRPC_HQUERY is a pointer to an [RPC_HQUERY](#) handle.

2.2.3 error_status_t

The type `error_status_t` is the return type from the interface methods; it is represented as an unsigned long. When the interface methods return successfully, the value is 0. Otherwise, it represents the failure that occurred, and its possible values are Win32 error codes, as specified in [\[MS-ERREF\]](#).

2.2.4 Structures

The following structures, sections [2.2.4.1](#) through [2.2.4.11](#), are not defined in the **Interface Definition Language (IDL)** file but are necessary to understand the information that is returned by the Performance Counter Query Protocol.

All multibyte data fields in the Performance Counter Query Protocol are little-endian. All the structures MUST begin on 8-byte boundaries, although the data that is contained within the structure need not be aligned to 8-byte boundaries.

2.2.4.1 _PERF_COUNTERSET_REG_INFO

The `_PERF_COUNTERSET_REG_INFO` structure contains information about the **counterset** and is used when enumerating **performance counter** information about the server.

```
typedef struct _PERF_COUNTERSET_REG_INFO {
    GUID CounterSetGuid;
    unsigned long CounterSetType;
    unsigned long DetailLevel;
    unsigned long NumCounters;
    unsigned long InstanceType;
} PERF_COUNTERSET_REG_INFO,
*PPERF_COUNTERSET_REG_INFO;
```

CounterSetGuid: A **GUID** uniquely identifying the counterset.

CounterSetType: Unused. MUST be set to 0, and MUST be ignored on receipt.

DetailLevel: The detail level of the counterset that is used to indicate the intended target audience. The value MUST be one of the following.

Value	Meaning
0x00000064	Novice level. Designed to be accessed by casual users who do not have detailed system knowledge.
0x000000C8	Advanced level. Designed to be accessed by information technology (IT) administrators who are monitoring multiple machines.

NumCounters: The number of counters that are defined in the counterset.

InstanceType: There can be a single or multiple active instances of the counterset, and the client must handle these instances differently. A single active instance of a counterset corresponds to a single active instance of a performance counter within that counterset. This field indicates whether the counterset is single, aggregate, or multiple-instance. The value MUST be one of the following.

Value	Meaning
0x00000000	Single instance. Only one instance of the counterset is active on the system at any time while the system is running.

Value	Meaning
0x00000002	Multiple instances. There can be several instances of the counterset active on the system at any time while the system is running.
0x00000004	Global aggregate. Performs an aggregation operation that is specified in the performance counter definition. The aggregation operation is performed on the client side for each counter in the counterset across all available and active instances of the counterset in the system.
0x00000006	Multiple-instance aggregate. Performs an aggregation operation that is specified in the performance counter definition. The aggregation operation is performed on the client side for each performance counter in the counterset across a client-specified set of instances of that counterset. For example, a client can average the value of counter "A" from counterset instances "1", "2", and "5".
0x0000000C	Global aggregate history. Performs an aggregation operation that is specified in the counter definition. The aggregation operation is performed on the client side for each performance counter in the counterset across all available instances of the counterset. The result of the aggregation operation can then be cached by the consumer and referenced for later use. For example, if a counter is deleted by the server between client queries, the client can use the value of the counter that was obtained in the last query for the aggregation operation.
0x00000016	Instance aggregate. Not implemented.

2.2.4.2 _PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO

The `_PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO` structure contains information on the counter and is used when enumerating **performance counter** information on the server.

```
typedef struct _PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO {
    unsigned long CounterId;
    unsigned long Type;
    unsigned int64 Attrib;
    unsigned long DetailLevel;
    long DefaultScale;
    unsigned long BaseCounterId;
    unsigned long PerfTimeId;
    unsigned long PerfFreqId;
    unsigned long MultiId;
    unsigned long AggregateFunc;
    unsigned long Reserved;
} _PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO,
*PPERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO;
```

CounterId: The numeric identifier of the counter. A performance counter's **CounterId** value MUST be unique within its counterset.

Type: The type of counter. The client MAY need to perform numeric operations on the value of the counter that is retrieved from the server to use it for analysis. Unless explicitly stated as an instantaneous value, the client MAY need to cache the value of the counter to compare it with the value from the next query. The value MUST be one of the following.

Value	Meaning
PERF_COUNTER_COUNTER 0x10410400	The counter data is a 32-bit value that indicates the rate of events being counted per second. To get the rate, the client takes the difference between counter values from two subsequent queries and divides it by the time difference between the two query time stamps. The unit of time is

Value	Meaning
	system time . The value is displayed as a rate of counts per second.
PERF_COUNTER_TIMER 0x20410500	The counter data is a 64-bit value that indicates the percentage of time that the server component updating the counter data was active over the sample interval. The client takes the difference in this value between subsequent queries and divides it by the sample interval; it displays this ratio as a percentage.
PERF_COUNTER_QUEUELEN_TYPE 0x00450400	The counter data is a 32-bit value that indicates the average change in the length of a queue over the sample interval. The client takes the difference in this value between subsequent queries and divides it by the sample interval.
PERF_COUNTER_LARGE_QUEUELEN_TYPE 0x00450500	This counter is similar to PERF_COUNTER_QUEUELEN_TYPE, except that the counter data is a 64-bit value.
PERF_COUNTER_100NS_QUEUELEN_TYPE 0x00550500	This counter is similar to PERF_COUNTER_LARGE_QUEUELEN_TYPE, except that the client assumes its clock is updated at a frequency of 100 nanoseconds for this calculation.
PERF_COUNTER_OBJ_TIME_QUEUELEN_TYPE 0x00650500	The counter data is a 32-bit value that indicates the average change in the length of a queue over the sample interval. The client takes the difference in this value between subsequent queries and divides it by the time difference that the server provides through the PerfTimeId counter, which contains the time stamp, and the PerfFreqId counter, which contains the frequency at which the server updates the time.
PERF_COUNTER_BULK_COUNT 0x10410500	This counter is similar to PERF_COUNTER_COUNTER, except that the counter data is a 64-bit value.
PERF_COUNTER_TEXT 0X00000B00	This counter is not a numeric counter, but rather Unicode text. The value is displayed as text.
PERF_COUNTER_RAWCOUNT 0x00010000	The counter data is an instantaneous 32-bit value and is not divided by a sample interval to calculate the average.
PERF_COUNTER_LARGE_RAWCOUNT 0x00010100	This counter is similar to PERF_COUNTER_RAWCOUNT, except that the counter data is a 64-bit value.
PERF_COUNTER_RAWCOUNT_HEX 0x00000000	The counter data is an instantaneous 32-bit value and is not divided by a sample interval to calculate the average. The value is displayed as a hexadecimal number.
PERF_COUNTER_LARGE_RAWCOUNT_HEX 0x00000100	This counter is similar to PERF_COUNTER_RAWCOUNT_HEX, except that the counter data is a 64-bit value.
PERF_SAMPLE_FRACTION 0x20C20400	The counter data is a 32-bit value that is used with another counter to calculate a ratio that is displayed as a percentage. The client takes the difference between this counter data value and divides it by the difference between the data value queries of the BaseCounterId counter.
PERF_SAMPLE_COUNTER 0x00410400	The 32-bit counter data is similar to the PERF_COUNTER_COUNTER, except that the system performance time is used to calculate the sample interval

Value	Meaning
	instead of the system time.
PERF_COUNTER_TIMER_INV 0x21410500	The 64-bit counter data is generally used to show inactive time. The client takes the difference in the counter data between two queries and then divides that by the sample interval, which is calculated by using the system performance time. This ratio is then subtracted from 1 and displayed as a percentage.
PERF_ELAPSED_TIME 0x30240500	The 64-bit counter data contains a time value from which the value of the PerfTimeId counter is subtracted. This difference is then divided by the value of the PerfFreqId counter, which contains the frequency at which the server updates the time.
PERF_SAMPLE_BASE 0x40030401	The 32-bit counter data is used as the BaseCounterId for calculations that involve PERF_SAMPLE_FRACTION and MUST be greater than 0.
PERF_AVERAGE_TIMER 0x30020400	The 32-bit counter data is generally used to indicate the average time for an operation. The client takes the difference in the counter data between subsequent queries and divides that by the frequency of the system clock. It then divides this value by the value of the difference between subsequent queries of the BaseCounterId counter, which would contain the number of operations.
PERF_AVERAGE_BASE 0x40030402	The 32-bit counter data is used as the BaseCounterId counter in calculations that involve PERF_AVERAGE_TIMER or PERF_AVERAGE_BULK.
PERF_AVERAGE_BULK 0x40020500	The 64-bit counter data is generally used to show an average metric, such as bytes, for an operation. The client takes the difference in this value between subsequent queries and divides that value by the difference in the value of the BaseCounterId counter.
PERF_OBJ_TIME_TIMER 0x20610500	The 64-bit counter data is used as a server-specific timer. The client takes the difference in the counter data between subsequent queries and then divides that by the difference in time. The time difference is calculated by taking the difference of the PerfTimeId counter between subsequent queries and dividing it by the value of the PerfFreqId counter.
PERF_PRECISION_100NS_TIMER 0x20570500	The 64-bit counter data is used as a precise elapsed timer. The client takes the difference in the counter data between subsequent queries and then divides that by the value of the difference in the BaseCounterId counter; the BaseCounterId counter represents a clock time that is assumed to be updated at a frequency of 100 nanoseconds.
PERF_PRECISION_SYSTEM_TIMER 0x20470500	The 64-bit counter data is used as an elapsed timer. The client takes the difference in the counter data from subsequent queries and divides it by the difference in the counter data of the BaseCounterId counter, which serves as a timestamp counter. The client assumes the frequency of the clock is the same as the system performance timer.
PERF_PRECISION_OBJECT_TIMER 0x20670500	The 64-bit counter data is used as a precise elapsed timer. The client takes the difference in the counter data between subsequent queries and divides that by the value of the difference in time. This difference is calculated by taking

Value	Meaning
	the difference between subsequent queries of the PerfTimeId counter and dividing it by the frequency, which is the value of the PerfFreqId counter.
PERF_100NSEC_TIMER 0x20510500	The 64-bit counter data is used to indicate the ratio of active time over elapsed time. The client takes the difference in the counter data between subsequent queries and then divides that by the sample interval; the frequency of the client clock is assumed to be 100 nanoseconds. The value is displayed as a percentage.
PERF_100NSEC_TIMER_INV 0x21510500	The 64-bit counter data is the inverse of the PERF_100NSEC_TIMER; it shows the ratio of inactive time over elapsed time. The client takes the difference in this counter value between subsequent queries and then divides it by the sample interval; this result is subtracted from 1 and then displayed as a percentage. The frequency of the client clock in this calculation is assumed to be 100 nanoseconds.
PERF_COUNTER_MULTI_TIMER 0x22410500	The 64-bit counter data is used to indicate the average ratio of active time over elapsed time; it is used when there are multiple instances, such as disks that are being monitored. The client takes the difference in the counter data between subsequent queries and divides it by the sample interval. The client uses the frequency of the system performance time to calculate elapsed time. This ratio is then divided by the value of the MultiId counter and is displayed as a percentage.
PERF_COUNTER_MULTI_TIMER_INV 0x23410500	The 64-bit counter data is the inverse of the PERF_COUNTER_MULTI_TIMER. The client takes the difference in the counter data between subsequent queries and divides it by the sample interval. The client uses the frequency of the system performance time. This value is then subtracted from the value of the MultiId counter and is displayed as a percentage.
PERF_100NSEC_MULTI_TIMER 0x22510500	The 64-bit counter data is used to indicate the average ratio of active time over elapsed time; it is used when there are multiple instances, such as disks that are being monitored. The client takes the difference in the counter data between subsequent queries and divides it by the sample interval. The client uses the frequency of 100 nanoseconds to calculate elapsed time. This ratio is then divided by the value of the MultiId counter and is displayed as a percentage.
PERF_100NSEC_MULTI_TIMER_INV 0x23510500	The 64-bit counter data is the inverse of the PERF_100NSEC_MULTI_TIMER. The client takes the difference in the counter data between subsequent queries and then divides it by the sample interval; the client uses the frequency of 100 nanoseconds to calculate elapsed time. This value is then subtracted from the value of the MultiId counter; it is displayed as a percentage.
PERF_RAW_FRACTION 0x20020400	The 32-bit counter data is used to show a ratio between two values. The client takes the counter data and divides it by the value of the BaseCounterId counter; it displays this ratio as a percentage.
PERF_RAW_BASE	The 32-bit counter data is used by the client in calculations involving the PERF_RAW_FRACTION counter. The client

Value	Meaning
0x40030403	SHOULD NOT display this counter.
PERF_LARGE_RAW_FRACTION 0x20020500	The counter data is similar to PERF_RAW_FRACTION, except that it is a 64-bit value.
PERF_LARGE_RAW_BASE 0x40030500	The 64-bit counter data is used by the client in calculations that involve PERF_LARGE_RAW_FRACTION, PERF_PRECISION_SYSTEM_TIMER, and PERF_PRECISION_100NS_TIMER counters.

Attrib: The counter attributes describe certain properties that can be combined in certain cases. The value MUST be one or more of the following.

Value	Meaning
0x0000000000000001	Reference. The query on the server MUST dereference the counter to obtain the value. <2>
0x0000000000000002	No display. Instructs the client consumer querying for performance counter data not to display the counter value.
0x0000000000000004	No group separator. Instructs the client consumer querying performance counter data to display the counter values as a single number without commas between digits.
0x0000000000000008	Display as real. Instructs the client consumer querying performance counter to display the counter value as a real number.
0x0000000000000010	Display as hexadecimal. Instructs the client consumer querying performance counter to display the counter value as a hexadecimal number.

Note that only certain combinations of the preceding possible values are allowed.

- The "Reference" value (0x0000000000000001) can be specified with any other value.
- The "No display" value (0x0000000000000002) MUST NOT be specified with the "No group separator", "Display as real" or "Display as hex" values.
- The "No group separator" (0x0000000000000004) or the "Display as real" (0x0000000000000008) values MUST NOT be specified with the "Display as hex" value.

DetailLevel: The detail level of the counter. The value MUST be one of the following.

Value	Meaning
0x00000064	Novice level. Designed to be accessed by casual users who do not have detailed system knowledge.
0x000000C8	Advanced level. Designed to be accessed by IT administrators who are monitoring multiple machines.

DefaultScale: Indicates the amount by which the counter value is scaled. Valid values are from 0xFFFFFFF6 to 0x0000000A (-10 to 10 decimal). For example, if the value of the counter is 0x0000000A (10 decimal) and the default scale is 0x00000002 (2 decimal), the counter value that is calculated by the client MUST be 0x000003E8 (1000 decimal).

BaseCounterId: The **CounterId** of another counter in the **counterset** whose value is used by the client in calculating this counter's value. The type of calculation depends of the type of the performance counter.

For example, the difference in the value between queries of a counter are divided by the difference in the value between queries of the counter whose **CounterId** is BaseCounterId.

The following counter types require a **BaseCounterId**.

Counter type	Base counter type
PERF_AVERAGE_TIMER	PERF_AVERAGE_BASE
PERF_AVERAGE_BULK	PERF_AVERAGE_BASE
PERF_LARGE_RAW_FRACTION	PERF_LARGE_RAW_BASE
PERF_PRECISION_SYSTEM_TIMER	PERF_LARGE_RAW_BASE
PERF_PRECISION_100NS_TIMER	PERF_LARGE_RAW_BASE
PERF_RAW_FRACTION	PERF_RAW_BASE
PERF_SAMPLE_FRACTION	PERF_SAMPLE_BASE

PerfTimeId: The **CounterId** of another counter in the counterset whose time value is used to calculate the value of this counter.

In certain cases, such as when calculating rate, it is necessary to gather a time value and take the difference between subsequent queries of this time value to calculate elapsed time on the client.

PerfTimeId specifies the **CounterId** of the counter, which MUST be of type PERF_COUNTER_LARGE_RAWCOUNT, in the counterset that will contain the time value that is used to calculate the rate of this counter. The following counter types require a **PerfTimeId** (for more information, see [\[MSFT-COUNTERTYPES\]](#)):

- PERF_COUNTER_OBJ_TIME_QUEUELEN_TYPE
- PERF_ELAPSED_TIME
- PERF_OBJ_TIME_TIMER
- PERF_PRECISION_OBJECT_TIMER

PerfFreqId: The **CounterId** of another counter in the counterset whose frequency value is used to calculate the value of this counter.

In certain cases, such as when rate is calculated, it is necessary to gather a time value and take the difference between subsequent queries of this time value. The time value is then divided by the frequency at which time is updated to calculate the elapsed time, in seconds, on the client.

PerfFreqId specifies the **CounterId** of the counter, which MUST be of type PERF_COUNTER_LARGE_RAWCOUNT, in the counterset whose value will contain the frequency at which time is updated to calculate the rate of this counter. The following counter types require a **PerfFreqId** (for more information, see [\[MSFT-COUNTERTYPES\]](#)):

- PERF_COUNTER_OBJ_TIME_QUEUELEN_TYPE
- PERF_ELAPSED_TIME
- PERF_OBJ_TIME_TIMER
- PERF_PRECISION_OBJECT_TIMER

MultiId: The **CounterId** of another counter within the current counterset that is used to calculate the value of this counter.

In certain cases, such as when rate counters are scaled, it is necessary to divide the difference in this counter value between queries by an additional value on the client. The **CounterId** of the counter is specified by **MultiId**. It MUST be of type PERF_COUNTER_RAWCOUNT in the counterset that is used as a divisor to this counter value. The following counter types require a **MultiId** (for more information, see [MSFT-COUNTERTYPES]):

- PERF_COUNTER_MULTI_TIMER
- PERF_100NSEC_MULTI_TIMER
- PERF_100NSEC_MULTI_TIMER_INV
- PERF_COUNTER_MULTI_TIMER_INV

AggregateFunc: The aggregation function to be performed by the client on the counter if the counterset to which the counter belongs is of type Global Aggregate, Multiple Instance Aggregate, or Global Aggregate History. The client specifies across which counter instances the aggregation are performed if the counterset type is Multiple Instance Aggregate; otherwise, the client MUST aggregate values across all instances of the counterset. One of the following values MUST be specified.

Value	Meaning
0x00000000	Undefined.
0x00000001	Total. The sum of the values of the returned counter instances.
0x00000002	Average. The average of the values of the returned counter instances.
0x00000003	Minimum. The minimum value of the returned counter instance values.
0x00000004	Maximum. The maximum value of the returned counter instance values.

Reserved: This is a reserved field. It MUST be set to 0, and MUST be ignored on receipt.

2.2.4.3 _STRING_BUFFER_HEADER

The _STRING_BUFFER_HEADER structure is used at the beginning of a counter string header block that is returned when retrieving the names or description strings of **performance counters**. For more information, see Figure 2 in section [3.1.4.1.2](#).

```
typedef struct _STRING_BUFFER_HEADER {
    DWORD dwSize;
    DWORD dwCounters;
} PERF_STRING_BUFFER_HEADER,
*PPERF_STRING_BUFFER_HEADER;
```

dwSize: The total size, in bytes, of the data that is returned.

dwCounters: The total number of counters in the **counterset**.

2.2.4.4 _STRING_COUNTER_HEADER

The _STRING_COUNTER_HEADER structure is used in a counter string header block.

```
typedef struct _STRING_COUNTER_HEADER {
    DWORD dwCounterId;
    DWORD dwOffset;
} PERF_STRING_COUNTER_HEADER,
```

```
*PPERF_STRING_COUNTER_HEADER;
```

dwCounterId: The CounterId of the **performance counter**.

dwOffset: The offset from the end of the set of _STRING_COUNTER_HEADER structures to which this structure belongs to its corresponding name or description. For more information, see figure 2 in section [3.1.4.1.2](#).

2.2.4.5 _PERF_INSTANCE_HEADER

The _PERF_INSTANCE_HEADER structure is used at the beginning of an instance block that is returned when enumerating **counterset** instances or when returning **performance counter** data from multiple instances.

```
typedef struct _PERF_INSTANCE_HEADER {  
    unsigned long Size;  
    unsigned long InstanceId;  
} PERF_INSTANCE_HEADER,  
*PPERF_INSTANCE_HEADER;
```

Size: The total size, in bytes, of the structure and the instance name.

InstanceId: The counterset instance identifier. Each active instance of a counterset can be identified by the combination of its instance name and instance identifier. Two active instances of a counterset SHOULD NOT have the same combination of instance name and instance identifier.

[<3>](#)

2.2.4.6 _PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER

The _PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER structure is used to identify **performance counters** when adding or removing counters from a query or when enumerating performance counter metadata on the server.

```
typedef struct PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER {  
    GUID CounterSetGuid;  
    unsigned long Status;  
    unsigned long Size;  
    unsigned long CounterId;  
    unsigned long InstanceId;  
    unsigned long Index;  
    unsigned long Reserved;  
} PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER,  
*PPERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER;
```

CounterSetGuid: The **GUID** of the **counterset**.

Status: A Win32 error code that indicates whether the operation was successful. Win32 error codes are specified in [\[MS-ERREF\]](#).

Size: The total size, in bytes, of the structure and the instance name. The structure is followed by the instance name, represented as a **Unicode string**.

CounterId: The numeric identifier of the counter.

InstanceId: The instance identifier of the counterset.

Index: The position in which the corresponding counter data is returned from a [PerflibV2QueryCounterData \(section 3.1.4.1.6\)](#) method call. For more information, see [PerflibV2QueryCounterInfo \(section 3.1.4.1.5\)](#).

Reserved: Clients MUST set this field to 0 and MUST ignore this field on receipt.

2.2.4.7 _PERF_DATA_HEADER

The `_PERF_DATA_HEADER` structure is used at the beginning of a sequence of counter header blocks that are returned when the client queries the server for **performance counter** values.

```
typedef struct _PERF_DATA_HEADER {
    unsigned long dwTotalSize;
    unsigned long dwNumCounter;
    unsigned __int64 PerfTimeStamp;
    unsigned __int64 PerfTime100NSec;
    unsigned __int64 PerfFreq;
    SYSTEMTIME SystemTime;
} PERF_DATA_HEADER,
*PPERF_DATA_HEADER;
```

dwTotalSize: The total size, in bytes, of the data.

dwNumCounter: The number of counters whose value is retrieved.

PerfTimeStamp: A high-resolution clock.

PerfTime100NSec: The number of 100 nanosecond intervals since January 1, 1601, in Coordinated Universal Time (UTC).

PerfFreq: The frequency of a high-resolution clock.

SystemTime: The time at which data is collected on the **provider** side. The format of this field is as specified in [\[MS-DTYP\]](#).

2.2.4.8 _PERF_COUNTER_HEADER

The `_PERF_COUNTER_HEADER` structure is used at the beginning of a counter header block.

```
typedef struct _PERF_COUNTER_HEADER {
    unsigned long dwStatus;
    unsigned long dwType;
    unsigned long dwSize;
    unsigned long Reserved;
} PERF_COUNTER_HEADER,
*PPERFCOUNTERHEADER;
```

dwStatus: A Win32 error code that indicates whether the operation was successful. Win32 error codes are specified in [\[MS-ERREF\]](#).

dwType: The **performance counter** type. The value MUST be one of the following.

Value	Meaning
PERF_ERROR_RETURN 0x00000000	An error occurred when the performance counter value was queried.
PERF_SINGLE_COUNTER	The query returned a single-instance performance counter value.

Value	Meaning
0x00000001	
PERF_MULTI_COUNTERS 0x00000002	The query returned multiple performance counter values.
PERF_MULTI_INSTANCES 0x00000004	The query returned values from multiple instances of a performance counter.
PERF_COUNTERSET 0x00000006	The query returned the values of all instances of all performance counters that belong to the counterset .

dwSize: The size, in bytes, of the structure and data.

Reserved: MUST be set to 0, and MUST be ignored on receipt.

2.2.4.9 _PERF_COUNTER_DATA

The _PERF_COUNTER_DATA structure is used in the counter header block.

```
typedef struct _PERF_COUNTER_DATA {
    unsigned long dwDataSize;
    unsigned long dwSize;
} PERF_COUNTER_DATA,
*PPERF_COUNTER_DATA;
```

dwDataSize: The size, in bytes, of the **performance counter** data.

dwSize: The size, in bytes, of the structure and performance counter data.

2.2.4.10 _PERF_MULTI_INSTANCES

The _PERF_MULTI_INSTANCES structure is used in the counter header block.

```
typedef struct _PERF_MULTI_INSTANCES {
    unsigned long dwTotalSize;
    unsigned long dwInstances;
} PERF_MULTI_INSTANCES,
*PPERF_MULTI_INSTANCES;
```

dwTotalSize: The size, in bytes, of the header and data.

dwInstances: The number of instances from which data is collected.

2.2.4.11 _PERF_MULTI_COUNTERS

The _PERF_MULTI_COUNTERS structure is used in the counter header block.

```
typedef struct _PERF_MULTI_COUNTERS {
    unsigned long dwSize;
    unsigned long dwCounters;
} PERF_MULTI_COUNTERS,
*PPERF_MULTI_COUNTERS;
```

dwSize: The size, in bytes, of this structure and the array of Performance Counter IDs.

dwCounters: The number of counters.

3 Protocol Details

The client side of the Performance Counter Query Protocol is simply a pass-through. Therefore, no additional timers or other states are required on the client side of the Performance Counter Query Protocol. Calls made by the higher-layer protocol or application are passed directly to the transport, and the results that are returned by the transport are passed directly back to the higher-layer protocol or application.

3.1 Server Details

The server handles client requests for any of the methods, as specified in section [3.1.4](#), and operates on the performance counters on the server.

3.1.1 Abstract Data Model

This section describes a conceptual model of possible data organization that an implementation maintains to participate in the Performance Counter Query Protocol. The described organization is provided to facilitate the explanation of how the protocol behaves. This document does not mandate that implementations adhere to this model as long as their external behavior is consistent with what is described in this document.

3.1.1.1 Countersets

Performance counters are organized into **countersets**. Each counterset is a logical grouping of one or more performance counters. A counterset is identified by a **GUID** and a name.

For example, a processor counterset can contain performance counters related to the system processor (CPU).

3.1.1.2 Counterset Instances

Depending on the entity that is updating the **performance counter** value, multiple instances of a **counterset** can exist. For example, a single-processor machine has only one instance of a counterset that contains processor-related performance counters; however, a dual-processor machine has two instances.

Each instance of a counterset is identified by a numeric ID and name.

3.1.1.3 Counters

Each **performance counter** in a **counterset** is identified by a numeric ID; a counter can be uniquely identified on the system by using the counterset **GUID**, counterset instance name or ID, and counter ID. Each performance counter can have a localized name and description, type, and detail level among other metadata fields. Depending on the type of performance counter, it can be necessary to use the value of other performance counters to calculate the value.

3.1.1.4 Providers

Performance counter values are updated by logical entities called **providers**. The providers are registered within the system, and they create the **counterset** instances using implementation-specific mechanisms. For each created instance, the system maintains information about the provider that is updating that instance.

3.1.1.5 Query Handles

Clients can perform two types of query operations on the server by using the Performance Counter Query Protocol: Browse the **counterset** and **performance counter** metadata on the server or query the performance counter values from the counterset instances. When a client requests browsing countersets or performance counter metadata (sections [3.1.4.1.1](#), [3.1.4.1.2](#), and [3.1.4.1.3](#)), the server does not associate any state with these requests, but simply sends to the client the available metadata on the system.

When a client wants to query the server for performance counter values from counterset instances, it uses the Performance Counter Query Protocol to create an RPC_HQUERY handle on the server. The server maintains a single table of query handles associating client connections to internal server states related to the connection. For each handle, the server keeps a list of performance counter identifiers (for more information about performance counter identifiers see section [2.2.4.6](#)). The client can add or remove performance counter identifiers from the list, as specified in section [3.1.4.1.7](#).

When the client makes the query operation (see section [3.1.4.1.6](#)), the server retrieves the performance counter values from the system by using system interfaces; the server passes to these interfaces the list of performance counter identifiers associated with the query handle. For each performance counter identifier, the system retrieves the performance counter value from its corresponding provider and returns it to the server. The server accumulates the values and sends the data to the client.

In addition, the client can enumerate the performance counter metadata about the performance counters it added to the query handle. In that case, the server returns the performance counter information that is associated with the RPC_HQUERY handle passed from the client (section [3.1.4.1.5](#)).

In certain cases, aggregation operations, such as addition or an average, can be performed by the client after it retrieves the performance counter values from the server. The counterset identifies whether an aggregation operation can be performed, and each performance counter in the counterset specifies a specific aggregation operation.

For example, a performance counter being queried by the client, associated with the RPC_HQUERY handle, can belong to a counterset of type Multiple Instance Aggregate. The AggregateFunc property of this performance counter, which is a member of the _PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO structure, can be set to value 0x00000001. In this case, all instances that the client queries will be returned; the client component of the performance counter infrastructure will use these values to calculate the total sum of the instances of that performance counter, to pass back to the requesting application.

When the client no longer needs to query the server for performance counter values, it closes the RPC_HQUERY handle; afterward, the server can free any resources that are associated with the handle.

3.1.2 Timers

No protocol timers are required—other than the internal ones that are used in **remote procedure calls** to implement resiliency to network outages, as specified in [\[MS-RPCE\]](#).

3.1.3 Initialization

None.

3.1.4 Message Processing Events and Sequencing Rules

The Performance Counter Query Protocol MUST indicate to the **RPC** runtime that it is to perform a strict **NDR** data consistency check at target level 6.0, as specified in [\[MS-RPCE\]](#) section 3.

The Performance Counter Query Protocol MUST indicate to the RPC runtime that it is to reject a NULL unique or full pointer with a nonzero conformant value, as specified in [MS-RPCE] section 3.

The Performance Counter Query Protocol MUST indicate to the RPC runtime through the **strict_context_handle** attribute that it is to reject use of context handles that are created by a method of a different RPC interface than this one, as specified in [MS-RPCE] section 3.

3.1.4.1 PerflibV2 Interface

The PerflibV2 interface is a set of methods that the client can use to enumerate **performance counter** metadata and query performance counter values on a server. The client can view all the counters that are installed on the system. After the client has decided which performance counters are of interest, it can open a query on the server and add the necessary counters. The client then queries these counters, upon which the server returns the values of the counters that are specified by the client. The client closes the query on the server once it has queried the counters for the necessary duration.

Methods in RPC Opnum Order

Method	Description
PerflibV2EnumerateCounterSet	Allows a client to enumerate the available countersets on a server. Opnum: 0
PerflibV2QueryCounterSetRegistrationInfo	Allows a client to enumerate metadata about a counterset or performance counter on a server. Opnum: 1
PerflibV2EnumerateCounterSetInstances	Retrieves all active instances of a counterset on a server. Opnum: 2
PerflibV2OpenQueryHandle	Opens a handle that is used to add, remove, or collect performance counters from a server. Opnum: 3
PerflibV2CloseQueryHandle	Closes the handle that is returned from the PerflibV2OpenQueryHandle method. Opnum: 4
PerflibV2QueryCounterInfo	Returns information on the performance counters. Opnum: 5
PerflibV2QueryCounterData	Retrieves performance counter data. Opnum: 6
PerflibV2ValidateCounters	Adds or removes performance counters from the query. Opnum: 7

These methods MUST not throw exceptions except for those that are thrown by the underlying **RPC** protocol, as specified in [MS-RPCE].

Many of these methods return data in buffers whose format is not specified in the IDL file. All structures that are returned in the data buffer MUST begin on 8-byte boundaries, and all multibyte data fields are little-endian.

3.1.4.1.1 PerflibV2EnumerateCounterSet (Opnum 0)

The `PerflibV2EnumerateCounterSet` method allows a client to enumerate the available **countersets** on a server.

```
error_status_t PerflibV2EnumerateCounterSet(  
    [in, string] wchar_t* szMachine,  
    [in, range(0, 256)] DWORD dwInSize,  
    [out] DWORD* pdwOutSize,  
    [out] DWORD* pdwRtnSize,  
    [out, size_is(dwInSize), length_is(* pdwOutSize)]  
        GUID* lpData  
);
```

szMachine: A **Unicode string** specifying a server name, which is passed directly to the counter provider. Counter providers can ignore the server name provided by **szMachine**.

dwInSize: The size of the buffer, in number of **GUIDs**.

pdwOutSize: On output, the number of GUIDs that are returned in the array. The server MUST set this value to zero if the value of **dwInSize** is less than the total number of GUIDs on the server.

pdwRtnSize: On output, the total number of GUIDs on the server.

lpData: The buffer that returns an array of GUIDs.

Return Values: This method MUST return zero (`ERROR_SUCCESS`) for success; otherwise, it MUST return one of the standard Windows errors, as specified in [\[MS-ERREF\]](#) section 2.2.

Return value/code	Description
0x00000000 ERROR_SUCCESS	The return value indicates success.
0x00000005 ERROR_ACCESS_DENIED	The server returns this value to the client if the authentication level of the client is less than <code>RPC_C_AUTHN_LEVEL_PKT_PRIVACY</code> .
0x00000008 ERROR_NOT_ENOUGH_MEMORY	This return value is used to indicate when the size of the client-provided buffer is not large enough to accommodate all of the GUID values that are being returned by the server.
0x0000000E ERROR_OUTOFMEMORY	This return value is used to indicate that the server, while attempting to return all of the appropriate GUIDs to the client, could not allocate memory.

3.1.4.1.2 PerflibV2QueryCounterSetRegistrationInfo (Opnum 1)

The `PerflibV2QueryCounterSetRegistrationInfo` method allows a client to enumerate metadata about a **counterset** or **performance counter** on a server.

```
error_status_t PerflibV2QueryCounterSetRegistrationInfo(  
    [in, string] wchar_t* szMachine,  
    [in] GUID* CounterSetGuid,  
    [in] DWORD RequestCode,  
    [in] DWORD RequestLCID,  
    [in, range(0, 134217728)] DWORD dwInSize,  
    [out] DWORD* pdwOutSize,  
    [out] DWORD* pdwRtnSize,  
    [out, size_is(dwInSize), length_is(* pdwOutSize)]  
        unsigned char* lpData
```

);

szMachine: A **Unicode string** specifying a server name, which is passed directly to the counter providers. Counter providers can ignore the server name provided by **szMachine**.

CounterSetGuid: The **GUID** of the counterset whose information needs to be retrieved; this can also be the GUID of the counterset to which the performance counters whose information is being queried belong.

RequestCode: The type of information on the counterset to retrieve. The value **MUST** be one of the following.

Value	Meaning
0x00000001	Return information about the counterset.
0x00000002	Return information about a performance counter.
0x00000003	Return the name of the counterset.
0x00000004	Return the description of the counterset.
0x00000005	Return the names of the performance counters.
0x00000006	Return the descriptions of the performance counters.
0x00000007	Return the name of the provider.
0x00000008	Return the GUID of the provider.
0x00000009	Return the English-language name of the counterset.
0x0000000A	Return the English-language names of the performance counters.

RequestLCID: When the value of *RequestCode* is 0x00000003, 0x00000004, 0x00000005, or 0x00000006, RequestLCID specifies the locale ID (as specified in [\[MS-LCID\]](#)), or is set to 0 to instruct the server to use its default language.

When the value of *RequestCode* is 0x00000002, RequestLCID specifies the counter ID.

When the value of *RequestCode* is 0x00000001, 0x00000007, 0x00000008, 0x00000009, or 0x0000000A, RequestLCID **MUST** be set to zero and ignored upon receipt. [<4>](#)

dwInSize: The size, in bytes, of the buffer.

pdwOutSize: The size, in bytes, of the data in the buffer pointed to by **lpData**.

pdwRtnSize: The necessary size, in bytes, to retrieve all the requested data.

lpData: The buffer that returns the requested data.

Return Values: This method **MUST** return zero (ERROR_SUCCESS) for success; otherwise, it **MUST** return one of the standard Windows errors, as specified in [\[MS-ERREF\]](#) section 2.2.

Return value/code	Description
0x00000000 ERROR_SUCCESS	The return value indicates success.
0x00000005	The server returns this value to the client if the authentication level of

Return value/code	Description
ERROR_ACCESS_DENIED	the client is less than RPC_C_AUTHN_LEVEL_PKT_PRIVACY.
0x00000057 ERROR_INVALID_PARAMETER	This return value indicates that there was a problem with the parameter that was passed by the client to the server. The server MUST return this value when: <i>RequestCode</i> (the RequestCode is not between 0x00000001 and 0x0000000A inclusive).
0x00001068 ERROR_WMI_GUID_NOT_FOUND	The server returns this value if it does not have a counterset with the same GUID as the one passed by the client through the CounterSetGuid parameter of the method. The server will also return this value if it cannot find the GUID of the provider to which the counterset belongs.
0x00000008 ERROR_NOT_ENOUGH_MEMORY	The server will return this value to the client if the <i>RequestCode</i> parameter is valid, but the buffer pointed to by lpData is not of sufficient size.
0x0000106A ERROR_WMI_ITEMID_NOT_FOUND	The server returns this error code when the value of <i>RequestCode</i> is 0x02 and a counterset with the GUID provided through the <i>CounterSetGuid</i> parameter exists, but the counter identifier is not found in the counterset.

The data that this method returns depends on the type of information that is requested, as denoted by the *RequestCode* parameter.

- If the value of *RequestCode* is 0x00000003, 0x00000004, 0x00000005, or 0x00000006, and the language specified by **RequestLCID** is not installed on the server, an error MUST be returned.
- If *RequestCode* = 0x00000001, the server returns information about the counterset. The server MUST return a [_PERF_COUNTERSET_REG_INFO](#) structure that is followed by a set of [_PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO](#) structures. The number of [_PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO](#) structures MUST be equal to the **NumCounters** field of the [PERF_COUNTERSET_REG_INFO](#) structure.

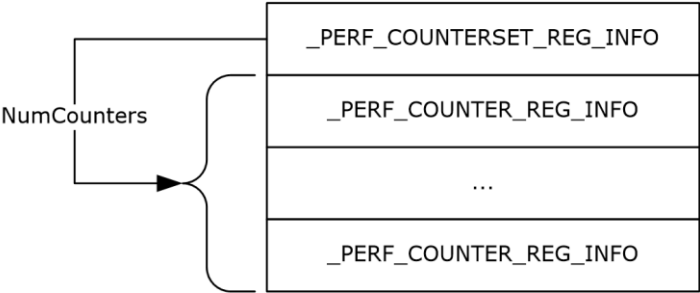


Figure 1: PerflibV2QueryCounterSetRegistrationInfo return if RequestCode = 0x00000001

The following diagram illustrates data size, alignment, and endianness.

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31
_PERF_COUNTERSET_REG_INFO (row 1, CounterSetGuid)																															

_PERF_COUNTERSET_REG_INFO (row 2, CounterSetGuid)
_PERF_COUNTERSET_REG_INFO (row 3, CounterSetGuid)
_PERF_COUNTERSET_REG_INFO (row 4, CounterSetGuid)
_PERF_COUNTERSET_REG_INFO (row 5, CounterSetType)
_PERF_COUNTERSET_REG_INFO (row 6, DetailLevel)
_PERF_COUNTERSET_REG_INFO (row 7, NumCounters)
_PERF_COUNTERSET_REG_INFO (row 8, InstanceType)
_PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO (row 1, CounterId)
_PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO (row 2, Type)
_PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO (row 3, Attrib)
_PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO (row 4, Attrib)
_PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO (row 5, DetailLevel)
_PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO (row 6, DefaultScale)
_PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO (row 7, BaseCounterId)
_PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO (row 8, PerfTimeId)
_PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO (row 9, PerfFreqId)
_PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO (row 10, MultiId)
_PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO (row 11, AggregateFunc)
_PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO (row 12, Reserved)

- If *RequestCode* = 0x00000002, the server returns information about a performance counter. The server MUST return a _PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO structure.

The following diagram illustrates data size, alignment, and endianness.

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31
_PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO (row 1, CounterId)																															
_PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO (row 2, Type)																															

_PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO (row 3, Attrib)
_PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO (row 4, Attrib)
_PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO (row 5, DetailLevel)
_PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO (row 6, DefaultScale)
_PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO (row 7, BaseCounterId)
_PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO (row 8, PerfTimeId)
_PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO (row 9, PerfFreqId)
_PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO (row 10, MultiId)
_PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO (row 11, AggregateFunc)
_PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO (row 12, Reserved)

- If *RequestCode* = 0x00000003, 0x00000004, or 0x00000009, the server returns either the localized name (*RequestCode* = 0x00000003) or description (*RequestCode* = 0x00000004). The *RequestCode* 0x00000009 specifies returning the name as an English-language string. The server MUST return a null-terminated Unicode string.
- If *RequestCode* = 0x00000005, 0x00000006, or 0x0000000A, the server returns either the localized names (*RequestCode* = 0x00000005) or descriptions (*RequestCode* = 0x00000006). The *RequestCode* 0x0000000A specifies returning the names of the counters as English-language strings. The server MUST return a [STRING_BUFFER_HEADER](#) structure that is followed by a set of [STRING_COUNTER_HEADER](#) structures and then a set of null-terminated Unicode strings and MUST be 8-byte aligned. The number of [_STRING_COUNTER_HEADER](#) structures MUST be equal to the **dwCounters** field of the [_STRING_BUFFER_HEADER](#) structure. The offset to the beginning of a string is the size of the [_STRING_BUFFER_HEADER](#) plus the size of the [_STRING_COUNTER_HEADER](#) structures that are multiplied by the number of counters plus the **dwOffset** value of the [_STRING_COUNTER_HEADER](#) structure.

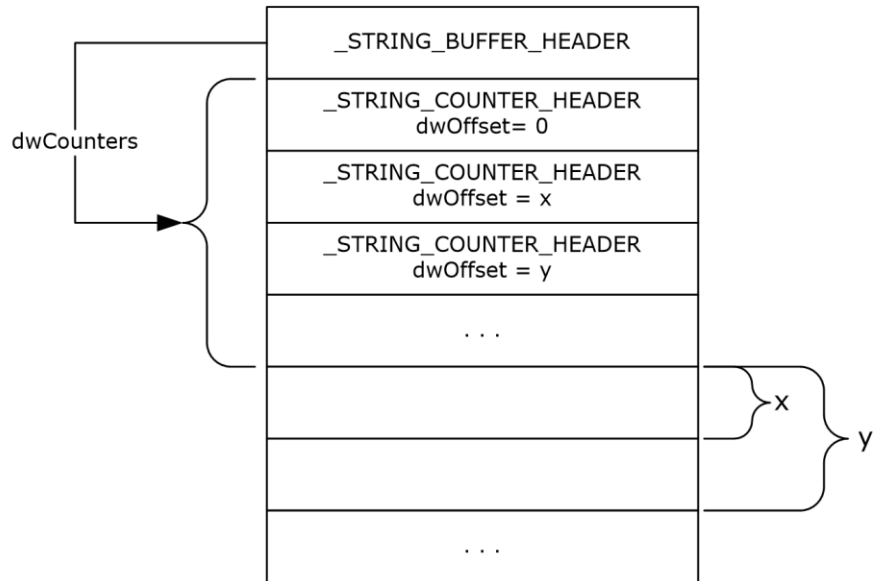


Figure 2: PerflibV2QueryCounterSetRegistrationInfo return if RequestCode = 0x00000005

The following diagram illustrates data size, alignment, and endianness. In this example, the names of two performance counters are returned (`STRING_BUFFER_HEADER.dwCounters == 2`). The name of the first counter is 6 bytes in length, while the name of the second counter is 8 bytes in length.

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31
_STRING_BUFFER_HEADER (row 1, dwSize)																															
_STRING_BUFFER_HEADER (row 2, dwCounters)																															
_STRING_COUNTER_HEADER (row 1, dwCounterId)																															
_STRING_COUNTER_HEADER (row 2, dwOffset)																															
_STRING_COUNTER_HEADER (row 1, dwCounterId)																															
_STRING_COUNTER_HEADER (row 2, dwOffset)																															
Unicode String Name of the first counter																															
Name of the First Counter																Unicode String Name of the Second Counter															
Unicode String Name of the second counter																															
Name of the Second Counter																Padding (MUST be uninitialized)															

- If *RequestCode* = 0x00000007, the server returns the name of the performance counter provider. The server MUST return a null-terminated Unicode string.
- If *RequestCode* = 0x00000008, the server returns the GUID of the performance counter provider. The server MUST return a GUID.

3.1.4.1.3 PerflibV2EnumerateCounterSetInstances (Opnum 2)

The PerflibV2EnumerateCounterSetInstances method retrieves all active instances of the client-specified **counterset** on the server.

```
error_status_t PerflibV2EnumerateCounterSetInstances(
    [in, string] wchar_t* szMachine,
    [in] GUID* CounterSetGuid,
    [in, range(0, 67108864)] DWORD dwInSize,
    [out] DWORD* pdwOutSize,
    [out] DWORD* pdwRtnSize,
    [out, size_is(dwInSize), length_is(* pdwOutSize)]
    unsigned char* lpData
);
```

szMachine: A **Unicode string** specifying a server name, which is passed directly to the counter providers. Counter providers can ignore the server name provided by **szMachine**.

CounterSetGuid: The **GUID** of the counterset whose instances are to be enumerated.

Return value/code	Description
0x00000000 ERROR_SUCCESS	The return value indicates success.
0x00000005 ERROR_ACCESS_DENIED	The server returns this value to the client if the authentication level of the client is less than RPC_C_AUTHN_LEVEL_PKT_PRIVACY.
0x00001068 ERROR_WMI_GUID_NOT_FOUND	The server returns this value when it cannot find a counterset with the GUID that was specified by the client in the CounterSetGuid parameter.
0x00000008 ERROR_NOT_ENOUGH_MEMORY	The server returns this value to the client when the buffer the client has provided is not large enough to accommodate the instance information.
0x00001069 ERROR_WMI_INSTANCE_NOT_FOUND	The server returns this value to the client when there are no active instances of the counterset whose information can be returned.
0x00001073 ERROR_WMI_INVALID_REGINFO	The server returns this to the client if, for any reason when trying to enumerate counterset instances, the information that the server expected was different than what the applications exposing performance counters returned. For example, the server (through some standard repository), expected information about one instance of a counterset to be returned (because it was specified as a single-instance counterset), but the application actually maintaining the information returned instance information about multiple instances of the counterset.
0x0000000E ERROR_OUTOFMEMORY	The server returns this value to the client if, for any reason as it tries to return the instance information of the specified counterset, it fails to allocate memory.

dwInSize: The size, in bytes, of the buffer.

pdwOutSize: The total size, in bytes, of the data that is returned and written to the buffer.

pdwRtnSize: The necessary size, in bytes, to retrieve all the requested data.

lpData: The buffer that contains the instances information for the counterset.

Return Values: This method MUST return zero (ERROR_SUCCESS) for success; otherwise, it MUST return one of the standard Windows errors, as specified in [\[MS-ERREF\]](#) section 2.2.

The server MUST return a data array in which each element is a [_PERF_INSTANCE_HEADER](#) structure that is followed by a null-terminated Unicode string instance name. The **size** field of the [_PERF_INSTANCE_HEADER](#) structure MUST be the size of the [_PERF_INSTANCE_HEADER](#) structure plus the space that is occupied by the instance name string; and MUST be an 8-byte multiple.

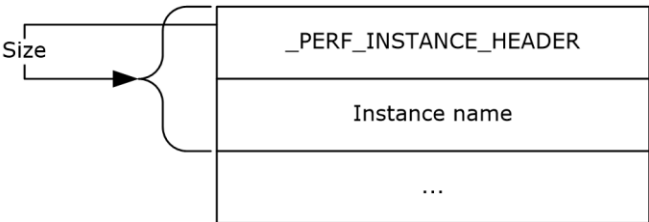


Figure 3: PerflibV2EnumerateCounterSetInstances return

The following diagram illustrates data size, alignment, and endianness. In this example, information about two instances of the counterset is returned by the server. The first instance name is 6 bytes in length, and the second instance name is 8 bytes in length. The two bytes in padding between the end of the first instance name string and the beginning of the next `_PERF_INSTANCE_HEADER` structure MUST be uninitialized and MUST be ignored by the client.

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	0	1
_PERF_INSTANCE_HEADER (row 1, Size)																															
_PERF_INSTANCE_HEADER (row 2, InstanceId)																															
Unicode string for First Instance Name (row 1)																															
First Instance Name (row 2)																Padding (MUST be uninitialized)															
_PERF_INSTANCE_HEADER (row 1, Size)																															
_PERF_INSTANCE_HEADER (row 2, InstanceId)																															
Unicode string for Second Instance Name (row 1)																															
Second Instance Name (row 2)																															

3.1.4.1.4 PerflibV2OpenQueryHandle (Opnum 3)

The PerflibV2OpenQueryHandle method returns a handle to the client that the client then uses to add, remove, and collect **performance counters** from the server.

```
error status t PerflibV2OpenQueryHandle(  
    [in, string] wchar_t* szMachine,  
    [out] PRPC_HQUERY phQuery  
);
```

szMachine: A **Unicode string** specifying a server name, which is passed directly to the counter providers. Counter providers can ignore the server name provided by **szMachine**.

phQuery: A handle used by other methods to add, remove, and collect performance counters.

Return Values: This method MUST return zero (ERROR_SUCCESS) for success; otherwise, it MUST return one of the standard Windows errors, as specified in [\[MS-ERREF\]](#) section 2.2.

Return value/code	Description
0x00000000 ERROR_SUCCESS	The return value indicates success.
0x00000005 ERROR_ACCESS_DENIED	The server returns this value to the client if the authentication level of the client is less than RPC_C_AUTHN_LEVEL_PKT_PRIVACY.
0x0000000E ERROR_OUTOFMEMORY	The server returns this value to the client if for any reason memory allocation fails as it tries to allocate memory to begin storing state about the client request.
0x000005AA ERROR_NO_SYSTEM_RESOURCES	The server returns this value if it cannot allocate other system resource to process the client request. This is not specifically memory about the client request or handle.

3.1.4.1.5 PerflibV2QueryCounterInfo (Opnum 5)

The PerflibV2QueryCounterInfo method returns information on the **performance counters** that belong to the performance counter query associated with the [RPC_HQUERY](#); these performance counters are associated with RPC_HQUERY by calling the [PerflibV2ValidateCounters](#) method. The server MUST return performance counter metadata information, stored in a [PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER](#) structure for each performance counter, for the performance counters that are associated with the RPC_HQUERY handle.

```
error_status_t PerflibV2QueryCounterInfo(  
    [in] RPC_HQUERY hQuery,  
    [in, range(0, 67108864)] DWORD dwInSize,  
    [out] DWORD* pdwOutSize,  
    [out] DWORD* pdwRtnSize,  
    [out, size is(dwInSize), length is(*pdwOutSize)]  
    unsigned char* lpData  
);
```

hQuery: The handle returned by the [PerflibV2OpenQueryHandle](#) method; an exception is thrown or an error is returned by RPC if the handle did not originate from the PerflibV2OpenQueryHandle method.

dwInSize: The size, in bytes, of the buffer.

pdwOutSize: The size, in bytes, of the data that is written to the buffer.

pdwRtnSize: The necessary size, in bytes, to retrieve all the requested data.

lpData: The buffer that contains the requested counter information.

Return Values: This method MUST return zero (ERROR_SUCCESS) for success; otherwise, it MUST return one of the standard Windows errors, as specified in [\[MS-ERREF\]](#) section 2.2.

Return value/code	Description
0x00000000 ERROR_SUCCESS	The return value indicates success.
0x00000005 ERROR_ACCESS_DENIED	The server returns this value to the client if the authentication level of the client is less than RPC_C_AUTHN_LEVEL_PKT_PRIVACY.
0x00000008 ERROR_NOT_ENOUGH_MEMORY	The server will return this value if the buffer pointed to by lpData is not of sufficient size to return the requested information back to the client.

The server MUST return a data array in which each element is a `_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER` structure that is followed by a null-terminated **Unicode string** instance name. The **index** field of the `_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER` structure MUST indicate the position of the corresponding `_PERF_COUNTER_HEADER` block in the array of returned `_PERF_COUNTER_HEADER` blocks by subsequent `PerflibV2QueryCounterData` method calls associated with the `RPC_HQUERY` handle.

The **status** field of the `_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER` structure SHOULD be set to a Win32 error code by the server and MUST be ignored by the client. The size field of the `_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER` structure MUST be an 8-byte multiple.

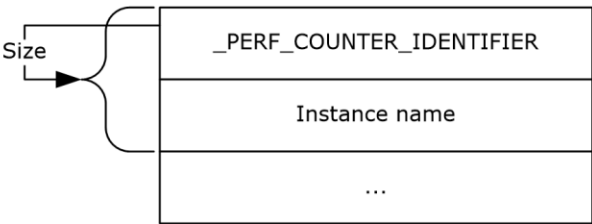


Figure 4: PerflibV2QueryCounterInfo return

The following diagram illustrates data size, alignment, and endianness. In this example, information about two counters is returned by the server. The first instance name is 6 bytes in length, and the second instance name is 8 bytes in length. The two bytes in padding between the end of the first instance name string and the beginning of the next `_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER` structure MUST be set to 0 by the server and MUST be ignored by the client.

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31
_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER (row 1, CounterSetGuid)																															
_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER (row 2, CounterSetGuid)																															

_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER (row 3, CounterSetGuid)	
_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER (row 4, CounterSetGuid)	
_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER (row 5, Status)	
_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER (row 6, Size)	
_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER (row 7, CounterId)	
_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER (row 8, InstanceId)	
_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER (row 9, Index)	
_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER (row 10, Reserved)	
Unicode string of Instance Name (row 1)	
Instance Name (row 2)	Padding (MUST be set to 0)
_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER (row 1, CounterSetGuid)	
_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER (row 2, CounterSetGuid)	
_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER (row 3, CounterSetGuid)	
_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER (row 4, CounterSetGuid)	
_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER (row 5, Status)	
_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER (row 6, Size)	
_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER (row 7, CounterId)	
_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER (row 8, InstanceId)	
_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER (row 9, Index)	
_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER (row 10, Reserved)	
Unicode string of Instance Name (row 1)	
Instance Name (row 2)	

3.1.4.1.6 PerflibV2QueryCounterData (Opnum 6)

The `PerflibV2QueryCounterData` method retrieves data for the **performance counters** associated with the query. Performance counters can be added or removed from queries by calling [PerflibV2ValidateCounters](#).

```
error_status_t PerflibV2QueryCounterData(  
    [in] RPC_HQUERY hQuery,  
    [in, range(0, 1073741824)] DWORD dwInSize,  
    [out] DWORD* pdwOutSize,  
    [out] DWORD* pdwRtnSize,  
    [out, size_is(dwInSize), length_is(* pdwOutSize)]  
    unsigned_char* lpData  
);
```

hQuery: The handle returned by the [PerflibV2OpenQueryHandle](#) method; an exception is thrown or an error is returned by RPC if the handle did not originate from the `PerflibV2OpenQueryHandle` method.

dwInSize: The size, in bytes, of the buffer.

pdwOutSize: The size, in bytes, of the data that is returned and written to the buffer.

pdwRtnSize: The necessary size, in bytes, to retrieve all the requested data.

lpData: The buffer that contains the requested counter information.

Return Values: This method MUST return zero (`ERROR_SUCCESS`) for success; otherwise, it MUST return one of the standard Windows error codes, as specified in [\[MS-ERREF\]](#) section 2.2.

Return value/code	Description
0x00000000 ERROR_SUCCESS	The return value indicates success.
0x00000005 ERROR_ACCESS_DENIED	The server returns this value to the client if the authentication level of the client is less than <code>RPC_C_AUTHN_LEVEL_PKT_PRIVACY</code> .
0x00000008 ERROR_NOT_ENOUGH_MEMORY	The server will return this value to the client if the size of the buffer pointed to by <code>lpData</code> is not of sufficient size to return the performance counter values to the client.

The server MUST return a [_PERF_DATA_HEADER](#) structure that is followed by a set of [_PERF_COUNTER_HEADER](#) blocks. The format of the `_PERF_COUNTER_HEADER` block MUST be determined by the **dwType** field of the `_PERF_COUNTER_HEADER` structure.

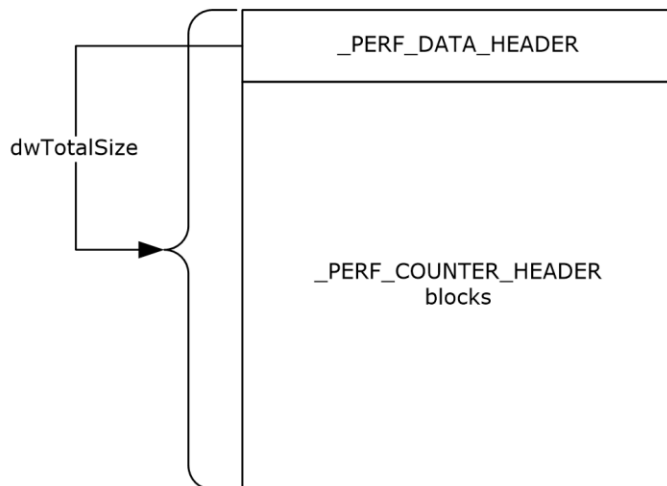


Figure 5: PerflibV2QueryCounterData return

The following diagram illustrates data size, alignment, and endianness.

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31	32	33	34	35	36	37	38	39	40	41	42	43	44	45	46	47	48	49	50	51	52	53	54	55	56	57	58	59	60	61	62	63	64	65	66	67	68	69	70	71	72	73	74	75	76	77	78	79	80	81	82	83	84	85	86	87	88	89	90	91	92	93	94	95	96	97	98	99	100	101	102	103	104	105	106	107	108	109	110	111	112	113	114	115	116	117	118	119	120	121	122	123	124	125	126	127	128	129	130	131	132	133	134	135	136	137	138	139	140	141	142	143	144	145	146	147	148	149	150	151	152	153	154	155	156	157	158	159	160	161	162	163	164	165	166	167	168	169	170	171	172	173	174	175	176	177	178	179	180	181	182	183	184	185	186	187	188	189	190	191	192	193	194	195	196	197	198	199	200	201	202	203	204	205	206	207	208	209	210	211	212	213	214	215	216	217	218	219	220	221	222	223	224	225	226	227	228	229	230	231	232	233	234	235	236	237	238	239	240	241	242	243	244	245	246	247	248	249	250	251	252	253	254	255	256	257	258	259	260	261	262	263	264	265	266	267	268	269	270	271	272	273	274	275	276	277	278	279	280	281	282	283	284	285	286	287	288	289	290	291	292	293	294	295	296	297	298	299	300	301	302	303	304	305	306	307	308	309	310	311	312	313	314	315	316	317	318	319	320	321	322	323	324	325	326	327	328	329	330	331	332	333	334	335	336	337	338	339	340	341	342	343	344	345	346	347	348	349	350	351	352	353	354	355	356	357	358	359	360	361	362	363	364	365	366	367	368	369	370	371	372	373	374	375	376	377	378	379	380	381	382	383	384	385	386	387	388	389	390	391	392	393	394	395	396	397	398	399	400	401	402	403	404	405	406	407	408	409	410	411	412	413	414	415	416	417	418	419	420	421	422	423	424	425	426	427	428	429	430	431	432	433	434	435	436	437	438	439	440	441	442	443	444	445	446	447	448	449	450	451	452	453	454	455	456	457	458	459	460	461	462	463	464	465	466	467	468	469	470	471	472	473	474	475	476	477	478	479	480	481	482	483	484	485	486	487	488	489	490	491	492	493	494	495	496	497	498	499	500	501	502	503	504	505	506	507	508	509	510	511	512	513	514	515	516	517	518	519	520	521	522	523	524	525	526	527	528	529	530	531	532	533	534	535	536	537	538	539	540	541	542	543	544	545	546	547	548	549	550	551	552	553	554	555	556	557	558	559	560	561	562	563	564	565	566	567	568	569	570	571	572	573	574	575	576	577	578	579	580	581	582	583	584	585	586	587	588	589	590	591	592	593	594	595	596	597	598	599	600	601	602	603	604	605	606	607	608	609	610	611	612	613	614	615	616	617	618	619	620	621	622	623	624	625	626	627	628	629	630	631	632	633	634	635	636	637	638	639	640	641	642	643	644	645	646	647	648	649	650	651	652	653	654	655	656	657	658	659	660	661	662	663	664	665	666	667	668	669	670	671	672	673	674	675	676	677	678	679	680	681	682	683	684	685	686	687	688	689	690	691	692	693	694	695	696	697	698	699	700	701	702	703	704	705	706	707	708	709	710	711	712	713	714	715	716	717	718	719	720	721	722	723	724	725	726	727	728	729	730	731	732	733	734	735	736	737	738	739	740	741	742	743	744	745	746	747	748	749	750	751	752	753	754	755	756	757	758	759	760	761	762	763	764	765	766	767	768	769	770	771	772	773	774	775	776	777	778	779	780	781	782	783	784	785	786	787	788	789	790	791	792	793	794	795	796	797	798	799	800	801	802	803	804	805	806	807	808	809	810	811	812	813	814	815	816	817	818	819	820	821	822	823	824	825	826	827	828	829	830	831	832	833	834	835	836	837	838	839	840	841	842	843	844	845	846	847	848	849	850	851	852	853	854	855	856	857	858	859	860	861	862	863	864	865	866	867	868	869	870	871	872	873	874	875	876	877	878	879	880	881	882	883	884	885	886	887	888	889	890	891	892	893	894	895	896	897	898	899	900	901	902	903	904	905	906	907	908	909	910	911	912	913	914	915	916	917	918	919	920	921	922	923	924	925	926	927	928	929	930	931	932	933	934	935	936	937	938	939	940	941	942	943	944	945	946	947	948	949	950	951	952	953	954	955	956	957	958	959	960	961	962	963	964	965	966	967	968	969	970	971	972	973	974	975	976	977	978	979	980	981	982	983	984	985	986	987	988	989	990	991	992	993	994	995	996	997	998	999	1000	1001	1002	1003	1004	1005	1006	1007	1008	1009	1010	1011	1012	1013	1014	1015	1016	1017	1018	1019	1020	1021	1022	1023	1024	1025	1026	1027	1028	1029	1030	1031	1032	1033	1034	1035	1036	1037	1038	1039	1040	1041	1042	1043	1044	1045	1046	1047	1048	1049	1050	1051	1052	1053	1054	1055	1056	1057	1058	1059	1060	1061	1062	1063	1064	1065	1066	1067	1068	1069	1070	1071	1072	1073	1074	1075	1076	1077	1078	1079	1080	1081	1082	1083	1084	1085	1086	1087	1088	1089	1090	1091	1092	1093	1094	1095	1096	1097	1098	1099	1100	1101	1102	1103	1104	1105	1106	1107	1108	1109	1110	1111	1112	1113	1114	1115	1116	1117	1118	1119	1120	1121	1122	1123	1124	1125	1126	1127	1128	1129	1130	1131	1132	1133	1134	1135	1136	1137	1138	1139	1140	1141	1142	1143	1144	1145	1146	1147	1148	1149	1150	1151	1152	1153	1154	1155	1156	1157	1158	1159	1160	1161	1162	1163	1164	1165	1166	1167	1168	1169	1170	1171	1172	1173	1174	1175	1176	1177	1178	1179	1180	1181	1182	1183	1184	1185	1186	1187	1188	1189	1190	1191	1192	1193	1194	1195	1196	1197	1198	1199	1200	1201	1202	1203	1204	1205	1206	1207	1208	1209	1210	1211	1212	1213	1214	1215	1216	1217	1218	1219	1220	1221	1222	1223	1224	1225	1226	1227	1228	1229	1230	1231	1232	1233	1234	1235	1236	1237	1238	1239	1240	1241	1242	1243	1244	1245	1246	1247	1248	1249	1250	1251	1252	1253	1254	1255	1256	1257	1258	1259	1260	1261	1262	1263	1264	1265	1266	1267	1268	1269	1270	1271	1272	1273	1274	1275	1276	1277	1278	1279	1280	1281	1282	1283	1284	1285	1286	1287	1288	1289	1290	1291	1292	1293	1294	1295	1296	1297	1298	1299	1300	1301	1302	1303	1304	1305	1306	1307	1308	1309	1310	1311	1312	1313	1314	1315	1316	1317	1318	1319	1320	1321	1322	1323	1324	1325	1326	1327	1328	1329	1330	1331	1332	1333	1334	1335	1336	1337	1338	1339	1340	1341	1342	1343	1344	1345	1346	1347	1348	1349	1350	1351	1352	1353	1354	1355	1356	1357	1358	1359	1360	1361	1362	1363	1364	1365	1366	1367	1368	1369	1370	1371	1372	1373	1374	1375	1376	1377	1378	1379	1380	1381	1382	1383	1384	1385	1386	1387	1388	1389	1390	1391	1392	1393	1394	1395	1396	1397	1398	1399	1400	1401	1402	1403	1404	1405	1406	1407	1408	1409	1410	1411	1412	1413	1414	1415	1416	1417	1418	1419	1420	1421	1422	1423	1424	1425	1426	1427	1428	1429	1430	1431	1432	1433	1434	1435	1436	1437	1438	1439	1440	1441	1442	1443	1444	1445	1446	1447	1448	1449	1450	1451	1452	1453	1454	1455	1456	1457	1458	1459	1460	1461	1462	1463	1464	1465	1466	1467	1468	1469	1470	1471	1472
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_PERF_DATA_HEADER (row 14, SystemTime)
_PERF_DATA_HEADER (row 15, SystemTime)
_PERF_DATA_HEADER (row 16, SystemTime)
_PERF_COUNTER_HEADER blocks

- If **dwType** = PERF_ERROR_RETURN (0x00000000), the _PERF_COUNTER_HEADER block MUST contain one _PERF_COUNTER_HEADER structure, and the **dwStatus** field of the structure indicates the error by using a Win32 error code. Win32 error codes are specified in [MS-ERREF].
- If **dwType** = PERF_SINGLE_COUNTER (0x00000001), the _PERF_COUNTER_HEADER block MUST contain a _PERF_COUNTER_HEADER structure that is followed by a [_PERF_COUNTER_DATA](#) structure and then followed by the counter value.

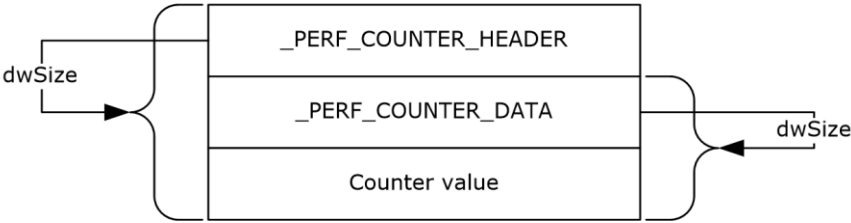


Figure 6: PerflibV2QueryCounterData return if dwType = PERF_SINGLE_COUNTER

The following diagram illustrates data size, alignment, and endianness.

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31
_PERF_COUNTER_HEADER (row 1, dwStatus)																															
_PERF_COUNTER_HEADER (row 2, dwType)																															
_PERF_COUNTER_HEADER (row 3, dwSize)																															
_PERF_COUNTER_HEADER (row 4, Reserved)																															
_PERF_COUNTER_DATA (row 1, dwDataSize)																															
_PERF_COUNTER_DATA (row 2, dwSize)																															
Counter value (Will be two rows if the counter value is 64-bits)																															

- If **dwType** = [PERF_MULTI_COUNTERS](#) (0x00000002), the _PERF_COUNTER_HEADER block MUST contain a _PERF_COUNTER_HEADER structure that is followed by a _PERF_MULTI_COUNTERS structure, followed by an array of performance counter IDs, followed by a sequence of _PERF_COUNTER_DATA blocks. Each _PERF_COUNTER_DATA block MUST contain a _PERF_COUNTER_DATA structure that is followed by the performance counter value. The order of

the elements in the array of counter IDs MUST be the same as the order of the corresponding performance counter values. The number of `_PERF_COUNTER_DATA` structures and the length of the performance counter ID array MUST be equal to the **dwCounters** field of the `_PERF_MULTI_COUNTERS` structure.

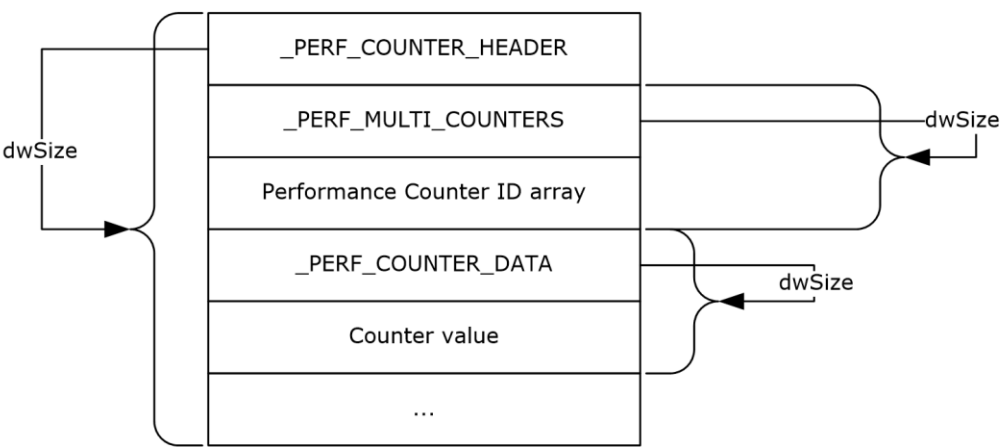


Figure 7: PerflibV2QueryCounterData return if dwType = _PERF_MULTI_COUNTERS

The following diagram illustrates data size, alignment, and endianness.

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31
_PERF_COUNTER_HEADER (row 1, dwStatus)																															
_PERF_COUNTER_HEADER (row 2, dwType)																															
_PERF_COUNTER_HEADER (row 3, dwSize)																															
_PERF_COUNTER_HEADER (row 4, Reserved)																															
_PERF_MULTI_COUNTERS (row 1, dwSize)																															
_PERF_MULTI_COUNTERS (row 2, dwCounters)																															
Counter ID array (Each element is one row, number of rows depends on number of counters)																															
_PERF_COUNTER_DATA (row 1, dwDataSize)																															
_PERF_COUNTER_DATA (row 2, dwSize)																															
Counter value (Will be two rows if the counter value is 64-bits)																															

- If **dwType** = [_PERF_MULTI_INSTANCES](#) (0x00000004), the `_PERF_COUNTER_HEADER` block MUST contain a `_PERF_COUNTER_HEADER` structure that is followed by a `_PERF_MULTI_INSTANCES` structure and then followed by a sequence of

[_PERF_INSTANCE_HEADER](#) blocks. Each `_PERF_INSTANCE_HEADER` block MUST contain a `_PERF_COUNTER_HEADER` structure that is followed by a `_PERF_COUNTER_DATA` structure and then followed by the performance counter value. The number of `_PERF_INSTANCE_HEADER` blocks MUST be equal to the **dwInstances** field of the `_PERF_MULTI_INSTANCES` structure.

The following diagram illustrates data size, alignment, and endianness.

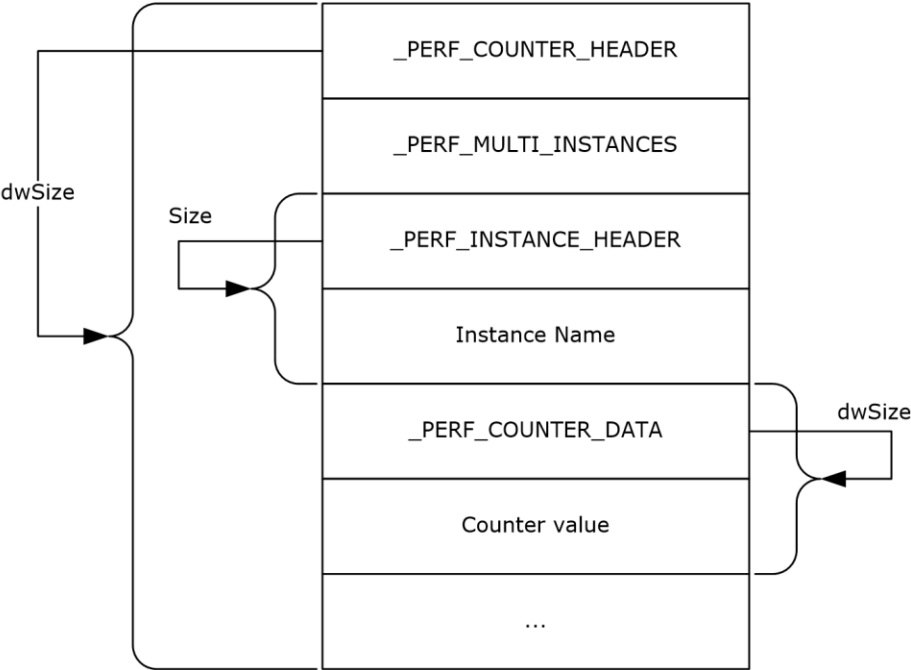


Figure 8: PerflibV2QueryCounterData return if dwType = _PERF_MULTI_INSTANCES

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31
_PERF_COUNTER_HEADER (row 1, dwStatus)																															
_PERF_COUNTER_HEADER (row 2, dwType)																															
_PERF_COUNTER_HEADER (row 3, dwSize)																															
_PERF_COUNTER_HEADER (row 4, Reserved)																															
_PERF_MULTI_INSTANCES (row 1, dwTotalSize)																															
_PERF_MULTI_INSTANCES (row 2, dwInstances)																															
_PERF_INSTANCE_HEADER (row 1, Size)																															
_PERF_INSTANCE_HEADER (row 2, InstanceId)																															

Unicode string of Instance Name (row 1)	
Instance Name (row 2)	Padding (MUST be set to 0)
_PERF_COUNTER_DATA (row 1, dwDataSize)	
_PERF_COUNTER_DATA (row 2, dwSize)	
Counter value (Will be two rows if the counter value is 64-bits)	

- If **dwType** = PERF_COUNTERSET (0x00000006), the _PERF_COUNTER_HEADER block MUST contain the following, in order: a _PERF_COUNTER_HEADER structure, a _PERF_MULTI_COUNTERS structure, the performance counter ID array, a _PERF_MULTI_INSTANCES structure, and a set of _PERF_INSTANCE_HEADER blocks. Each _PERF_INSTANCE_HEADER block MUST contain a _PERF_INSTANCE_HEADER structure that is followed by a sequence of _PERF_COUNTER_DATA blocks, and each _PERF_COUNTER_DATA block MUST contain a _PERF_COUNTER_DATA structure that is followed by the performance counter value. The number of _PERF_COUNTER_DATA blocks MUST be equal to the **dwCounters** field of the _PERF_MULTI_COUNTERS structure and the length of the performance counter ID array. The order of the elements in the array of counter IDs MUST be the same as the order of the corresponding performance counter values. The number of _PERF_INSTANCE_HEADER blocks MUST be equal to the **dwInstances** field of the _PERF_MULTI_INSTANCES structure.

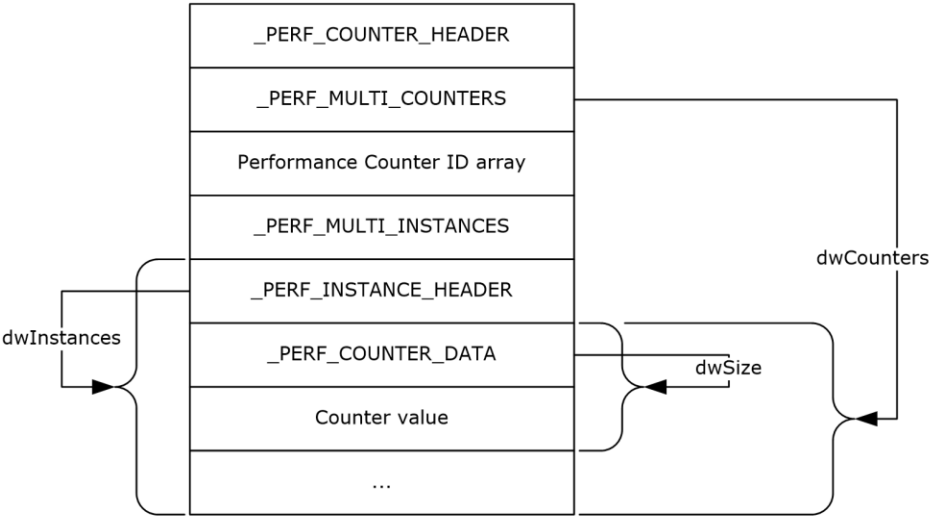


Figure 9: PerflibV2QueryCounterData return if dwType = PERF_COUNTERSET

The following diagram illustrates data size, alignment, and endianness.

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31
_PERF_COUNTER_HEADER (row 1, dwStatus)																															
_PERF_COUNTER_HEADER (row 2, dwType)																															

_PERF_COUNTER_HEADER (row 3, dwSize)
_PERF_COUNTER_HEADER (row 4, Reserved)
_PERF_MULTI_COUNTERS (row 1, dwSize)
_PERF_MULTI_COUNTERS (row 2, dwCounters)
Counter ID array (Each element is one row; number of rows depends on number of counters)
_PERF_MULTI_INSTANCES (row 1, dwTotalSize)
_PERF_MULTI_INSTANCES (row 2, dwInstances)
_PERF_INSTANCE_HEADER (row 1, Size)
_PERF_INSTANCE_HEADER (row 2, InstanceId)
_PERF_COUNTER_DATA (row 1, dwDataSize)
_PERF_COUNTER_DATA (row 2, dwSize)
Counter value (Will be two rows if the counter value is 64-bits)

3.1.4.1.7 PerflibV2ValidateCounters (Opnum 7)

This PerflibV2ValidateCounters method either adds or removes **performance counters** from the query.

```
error_status_t PerflibV2ValidateCounters(
    [in] RPC HQUERY hQuery,
    [in, range(0, 67108864)] DWORD dwInSize,
    [in, out, size_is(dwInSize)] unsigned char* lpData,
    [in] DWORD dwAdd
);
```

hQuery: The handle that is created by the [PerflibV2OpenQueryHandle](#) method; an exception is thrown or an error is returned by RPC if the handle did not originate from the PerflibV2OpenQueryHandle method.

dwInSize: The size, in bytes, of the buffer.

lpData: The buffer that contains the counter information to add to, or remove from, the query. The server will return this buffer after it has attempted to add or remove the specified counters; the **Status** field of each [_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER](#) structure will contain information about whether or not the server was successful.

dwAdd: A Boolean value that indicates if counters are being added to, or removed from, the query. If counters are being added, this MUST be set to TRUE; otherwise, it MUST be set to FALSE.

Return Values: This method MUST return zero (ERROR_SUCCESS) for success; otherwise, it MUST return one of the standard Windows error codes, as specified in [\[MS-ERREF\]](#) section 2.2.

Return value/code	Description
0x00000000 ERROR_SUCCESS	The return value indicates success.
0x00000005 ERROR_ACCESS_DENIED	The server returns this value to the client if the authentication level of the client is less than RPC_C_AUTHN_LEVEL_PKT_PRIVACY.
0x00000057 ERROR_INVALID_PARAMETER	The server returns this value to the client for any of the following reasons: - dwSize is less than the size of the _PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER structure (this condition would prevent the server from returning information about one counter). - The size of a single _PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER structure that is passed into the buffer by the client is smaller than the expected size of a _PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER structure.
0x0000000E ERROR_OUTOFMEMORY	The server will return this value to the client if, in the process of completing the client's request of adding or removing performance counters from the query, a memory allocation fails.

Errors are returned to the client by the server in one of two ways: the first is if the performance counter infrastructure on the server could not add or remove performance counters from the query; the second is if the **provider** that is exposing the performance counter returns an error, in which case the performance counter infrastructure passes the error back to the client.

When the `PerflibV2ValidateCounters` method returns, the **Status** field of each `_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER` sent to the server will have the result of whether or not the server was able to successfully add or remove that particular performance counter from the query that is identified by the handle `hQuery`.

If the performance counter infrastructure is setting the Status field to an error value, then it MUST be one of the following values.

Return value/code	Description
0x00000000 ERROR_STATUS	The return value indicates success. The counter was either successfully added or removed from the query.
0x00001068 ERROR_WMI_GUID_NOT_FOUND	The server cannot find the GUID that was passed by the client in the <code>CounterSetGuid</code> field of the <code>_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER</code> structure.
0x0000106A ERROR_WMI_ITEMID_NOT_FOUND	The server cannot find the counter whose numeric identifier is in the <code>CounterId</code> field of the <code>_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER</code> structure.
0x00000003 ERROR_PATH_NOT_FOUND	The server cannot find an active instance with the name that was placed after the <code>_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER</code> structure.
0x000000B7 ERROR_ALREADY_EXISTS	The client tried to add a performance counter that has already been added in a previous call to <code>PerflibV2ValidateCounters</code> .
ERROR_INVALID_PARAMETER 0x00000057	The server will return this value in the Status field of the <code>_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER</code> either when the <code>_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER</code> is corrupt, or if the server cannot find the counter to delete from the query that is specified by the structure.
0x0000000E	The server will return this value to the client if, either in the process of adding or removing a counter from a query, a memory allocation failure

Return value/code	Description
ERROR_OUTOFMEMORY	occurred.

When this method is called, the buffer MUST contain an array of `_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER` blocks that reference the performance counters to add to, or remove from, the query. Each `_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER` block MUST contain a `_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER` structure; a multiple-instance counter set `_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER` structure MUST be followed by a null-terminated **Unicode** string instance name, while a single-instance counter set `_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER` structure MUST be followed by a string instance name. Setting the **CounterId** field of the `_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER` structure to 0xFFFFFFFF indicates a wildcard character. Setting the instance name string to "*" indicates a wildcard character.

When the method returns, the **Status** field of each `_PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER` structure in the array MUST specify if the operation succeeded for the counters that are referenced by that structure.

3.1.4.1.8 PerflibV2CloseQueryHandle (Opnum 4)

The `PerflibV2CloseQueryHandle` method closes the handle that is returned from the [PerflibV2OpenQueryHandle](#) method.

```
error_status_t PerflibV2CloseQueryHandle(
    [in, out] PRPC_HQUERY phQuery
);
```

phQuery: A handle that is created by the `PerflibV2OpenQueryHandle` method. An exception is thrown or an error is returned by **RPC** if the handle did not originate from the `PerflibV2OpenQueryHandle` method. On method return, *phQuery* MUST be set to NULL.

Return Values: This method MUST return zero (`ERROR_SUCCESS`) for success; otherwise, it MUST return one of the standard Windows errors, as specified in [\[MS-ERREF\]](#) section 2.2.

Return value/code	Description
0x00000000 ERROR_SUCCESS	The return value indicates success.
0x00000005 ERROR_ACCESS_DENIED	The server returns this value to the client if the authentication level of the client is less than <code>RPC_C_AUTHN_LEVEL_PKT_PRIVACY</code> . The opened handle, <i>phQuery</i> , remains in that state until the client calls <code>PerflibV2CloseQueryHandle</code> with authentication level <code>RPC_C_AUTHN_LEVEL_PKT_PRIVACY</code> .

3.1.5 Timer Events

No timer events are required except for the events that are maintained in the underlying **RPC transport**.

3.1.6 Other Local Events

There are no local events inherently associated with the Performance Counter Query Protocol.

3.2 Client Details

3.2.1 Abstract Data Model

The state information that is required for successful operation of the Performance Counter Query Protocol is primarily stored on the server; other than the handle that is obtained from the [PerflibV2OpenQueryHandle \(section 3.1.4.1.4\)](#) method, all information such as the list of **performance counters** being queried is stored on the server.

If the client simply wants to either enumerate the available **countersets** or counterset instances on the server, or retrieve information about the counterset or counters that belong to the counterset, it does not need to establish a handle with the server by calling the [PerflibV2OpenQueryHandle](#) method. The client can simply call the [PerflibV2EnumerateCounterSet \(section 3.1.4.1.1\)](#), [PerflibV2EnumerateCounterSetInstances \(section 3.1.4.1.3\)](#), or [PerflibV2QueryCounterSetRegistrationInfo \(section 3.1.4.1.2\)](#) methods to retrieve the necessary information from the server.

If the client wants to query for performance counter data, or performance counter metadata associated with a particular query, from the server, then it first creates a handle. The client creates a handle by calling the [PerflibV2OpenQueryHandle](#) method. The server, upon receiving this call, stores the client machine information it receives from the RPC layer. The server also uses this handle to associate back to the client the performance counter2 that the client adds to the query by calling [PerflibV2ValidateCounters \(section 3.1.4.1.7\)](#). The server then returns this handle back to the client. The purpose of the handle is for the server to be able to distinguish between different client performance counter queries; the information that is passed back to the client, in the form of an [RPC_HQUERY \(section 2.2.1\)](#) handle, only contains the information necessary for the server to distinguish between separate queries. The client does not have knowledge of the contents or structure of the handle. For example, a specific implementation of the Performance Counter Query Protocol MAY return back a 32-bit unsigned numeric identifier as an [RPC_HQUERY](#) handle to the client; the client will then use this [RPC_HQUERY](#) handle, without explicit knowledge that the representation is a 32-bit unsigned integer, in subsequent communication to the server to query for performance counter data.

When the client has completed its necessary communication with the server, it closes the handle it obtained from the server by calling [PerflibV2CloseQueryHandle](#). This allows the server to free any information it retained with respect to the client's query (such as the list of performance counters that were being queried). The client can also free the memory that is associated with the [RPC_HQUERY](#) handle.

3.2.2 Timers

No protocol timers are required—other than those internal ones that are used in **remote procedure calls** to implement resiliency to network outages, as specified in [\[MS-RPCE\]](#).

3.2.3 Initialization

There is no client-side initialization.

3.2.4 Message Processing Events and Sequencing Rules

The Performance Counter Query Protocol MUST indicate to the **RPC** runtime that it is to perform a strict **NDR** data consistency check at target level 6.0, as specified in [\[MS-RPCE\]](#) section 3.

The Performance Counter Query Protocol MUST indicate to the RPC runtime that it is to reject a NULL unique or full pointer with a nonzero conformant value, as specified in [\[MS-RPCE\]](#) section 3.

3.2.5 Timer Events

No timer events are required except for the events that are maintained in the underlying **RPC transport**.

3.2.6 Other Local Events

There are no client-specific local events.

4 Protocol Examples

The following example demonstrates the usage of the Performance Counter Query Protocol. The client queries the value of certain **performance counters** that are organized into one **counterset** that is found on the server.

4.1 Querying for Performance Counter Data

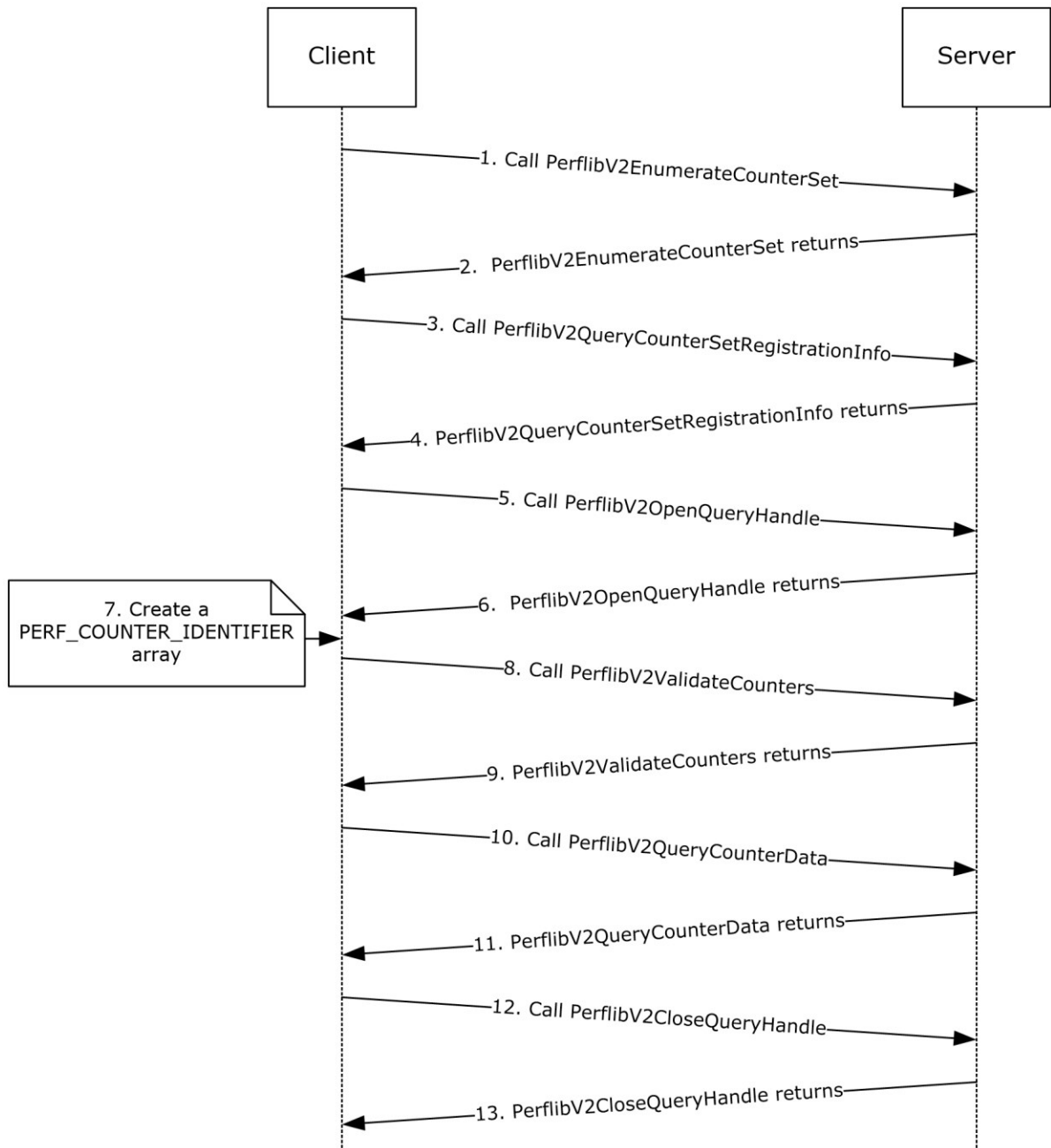


Figure 10: Querying for performance counter data

1. The client calls [PerflibV2EnumerateCounterSet](#) on the server.
2. The server returns all the available **countersets** to the client.
3. The client selects a counterset based on **GUID** and calls [PerflibV2QueryCounterSetRegistrationInfo](#) by using RequestCode = 0x00000001.
4. The server returns the counterset information of the counterset that is specified by the GUID in [PerflibV2QueryCounterSetRegistrationInfo](#), in addition to information about the **performance counters** that belong to the counterset.
5. To query the performance counter data of certain counters, the client calls [PerflibV2OpenQueryHandle](#) to open a handle to a query on the server.
6. The server returns a handle to a query; the client uses this handle to specify the performance counters whose values are to be queried.
7. The client, using the information that was returned from [PerflibV2QueryCounterSetRegistrationInfo](#), specifies the performance counters from the counterset that are to be queried.
8. The client calls [PerflibV2ValidateCounters](#) with the *dwAdd* parameter set to TRUE to add the counters to the query that is specified by the handle that is returned in step 6.
9. The server adds the performance counter information to the query that is specified by the handle and returns.
10. The client calls [PerflibV2QueryCounterData](#) to retrieve the values of the performance counters that are stored in the query that is specified by the handle.
11. The server returns the values of the performance counters in the query that is specified by the handle.
12. The client calls [PerflibV2CloseQueryHandle](#) to close the handle that it obtained in step 6 because it is finished querying the server.
13. The server releases all resources that are associated with the query that is specified by the handle and returns.

5 Security

The following sections specify security considerations for implementers of the Performance Counter Query Protocol.

5.1 Security Considerations for Implementers

The Performance Counter Query Protocol introduces no security considerations except for those that are applicable to **RPC**. Specifically, the client is required to use the `RPC_C_AUTHN_LEVEL_PKT_PRIVACY` authentication level.

5.2 Index of Security Parameters

Security parameter	Section
None	N/A

6 Appendix A: Full IDL

For ease of implementation, the full **IDL** is provided below, where "ms-dtyp.idl" is the IDL found in [\[MS-DTYP\]](#) Appendix A.

```
import "ms-dtyp.idl";

[
    uuid(da5a86c5-12c2-4943-ab30-7f74a813d853),
    pointer default(unique),
    version(1.0)
]

interface PerflibV2
{

    typedef [context_handle] HANDLE RPC_HQUERY;
    typedef RPC_HQUERY * PRPC_HQUERY;

    error_status_t
    PerflibV2EnumerateCounterSet(
        [ in, string ] wchar_t * szMachine,
        [ in, range(0, 256) ] DWORD dwInSize,
        [ out ] DWORD * pdwOutSize,
        [ out ] DWORD * pdwRtnSize,
        [ out, size_is(dwInSize), length_is(* pdwOutSize) ]
            GUID * lpData
    );

    error_status_t
    PerflibV2QueryCounterSetRegistrationInfo(
        [ in, string ] wchar_t * szMachine,
        [ in ] GUID * CounterSetGuid,
        [ in ] DWORD RequestCode,
        [ in ] DWORD RequestLCID,
        [ in, range(0, 134217728) ] DWORD dwInSize,
        [ out ] DWORD * pdwOutSize,
        [ out ] DWORD * pdwRtnSize,
        [ out, size_is(dwInSize), length_is(* pdwOutSize) ] unsigned char *
            lpData
    );

    error_status_t
    PerflibV2EnumerateCounterSetInstances(
        [ in, string ] wchar_t * szMachine,
        [ in ] GUID * CounterSetGuid,
        [ in, range(0, 67108864) ] DWORD dwInSize,
        [ out ] DWORD * pdwOutSize,
        [ out ] DWORD * pdwRtnSize,
        [ out, size_is(dwInSize), length_is(* pdwOutSize) ] unsigned char *
            lpData
    );

    error_status_t
    PerflibV2OpenQueryHandle(
        [ in, string ] wchar_t * szMachine,
        [ out ] PRPC_HQUERY phQuery
    );

    error_status_t
    PerflibV2CloseQueryHandle(
        [ in, out ] PRPC_HQUERY phQuery
    );

    error_status_t
    PerflibV2QueryCounterInfo(
        [ in ] RPC_HQUERY hQuery,
```

```

    [ in, range(0, 67108864) ] DWORD dwInSize,
    [ out ] DWORD *      pdwOutSize,
    [ out ] DWORD *      pdwRtnSize,
    [ out, size_is(dwInSize), length_is(* pdwOutSize) ] unsigned char *
        lpData
);

error_status_t
PerflibV2QueryCounterData(
    [ in ] RPC_HQUERY hQuery,
    [ in, range(0, 1073741824) ] DWORD dwInSize,
    [ out ] DWORD *      pdwOutSize,
    [ out ] DWORD *      pdwRtnSize,
    [ out, size_is(dwInSize), length_is(* pdwOutSize) ] unsigned char *
        lpData
);

error_status_t
PerflibV2ValidateCounters(
    [ in ] RPC_HQUERY hQuery,
    [ in, range(0, 67108864) ] DWORD dwInSize,
    [ in, out, size_is(dwInSize) ] unsigned char * lpData,
    [ in ] DWORD dwAdd
);
}

```

7 Appendix B: Product Behavior

The information in this specification is applicable to the following Microsoft products or supplemental software. References to product versions include updates to those products.

The terms "earlier" and "later", when used with a product version, refer to either all preceding versions or all subsequent versions, respectively. The term "through" refers to the inclusive range of versions. Applicable Microsoft products are listed chronologically in this section.

Windows Client

- Windows Vista operating system
- Windows 7 operating system
- Windows 8 operating system
- Windows 8.1 operating system
- Windows 10 operating system
- Windows 11 operating system

Windows Server

- Windows Server 2008 operating system
- Windows Server 2008 R2 operating system
- Windows Server 2012 operating system
- Windows Server 2012 R2 operating system
- Windows Server 2016 operating system
- Windows Server operating system
- Windows Server 2019 operating system
- Windows Server 2022 operating system
- Windows Server 2025 operating system

Exceptions, if any, are noted in this section. If an update version, service pack or Knowledge Base (KB) number appears with a product name, the behavior changed in that update. The new behavior also applies to subsequent updates unless otherwise specified. If a product edition appears with the product version, behavior is different in that product edition.

Unless otherwise specified, any statement of optional behavior in this specification that is prescribed using the terms "SHOULD" or "SHOULD NOT" implies product behavior in accordance with the SHOULD or SHOULD NOT prescription. Unless otherwise specified, the term "MAY" implies that the product does not follow the prescription.

[<1> Section 2.1](#): Applicable Windows Server releases will impersonate the client; the minimum impersonation level is `RPC_C_IMP_LEVEL_IMPERSONATE`. Windows only allows system administrators, members of the **Performance Log Users Group**, and members of the **Performance Monitor Users Group** to perform operations that are related to querying **performance counter** data or metadata. For more information on how an **AS** allows servers to act on the behalf of clients, see [\[MSDN-IMPLVL\]](#).

[<2> Section 2.2.4.2](#): Windows applications that use the performance counter infrastructure organize the performance counter into countersets. In order to update a performance counter, the application

must first create an active instance of that counterset; this in turn will create an active instance of the performance counter that belongs to that counterset. The application can then update that instance of the performance counter with the appropriate values.

On Windows, when an application wants to create an active instance of a counterset, the performance counter infrastructure will allocate memory in the application's process space to store the values of the different performance counters belonging to that instance of the counterset. The application then makes a method call to update a particular performance counter; this function finds the appropriate place in the memory where the counter value for the performance counter being updated resides, and updates that memory with the new value. When a client queries the performance counter value, the performance counter infrastructure simply copies the contents of the memory corresponding to that performance counter instance.

Alternatively, an application can provide a pointer to the performance counter. Thus, when the application creates an instance of the performance counter, the memory space that would normally contain the performance counter value instead contains a pointer to the variable containing the performance counter value. This is done by calling a method that initializes the memory contents of that performance counter instance to be the address of a variable. Thus, when a client queries for the performance counter, the infrastructure can't simply copy the contents of the memory; it must use that memory as an address to find the actual performance counter value. In order to instruct the infrastructure that the contents of the memory corresponding to a performance counter instance is an address and not the actual performance counter value, the **Attrib** field of the `_PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO` structure that defines the performance counter must be set to Reference (0x0000000000000001).

<3> [Section 2.2.4.5](#): Windows does not enforce that the combination of instance name and instance be unique for a particular counterset.

<4> [Section 3.1.4.1.2](#): Windows Vista and later and Windows Server 2008 and later incorrectly attempt to load the resources that correspond to *RequestCode* when *RequestCode* equals 0x00000001, 0x00000007, 0x00000008, 0x00000009, or 0x0000000A; if they are unable to do so, Windows returns an error code.

8 Change Tracking

This section identifies changes that were made to this document since the last release. Changes are classified as Major, Minor, or None.

The revision class **Major** means that the technical content in the document was significantly revised. Major changes affect protocol interoperability or implementation. Examples of major changes are:

- A document revision that incorporates changes to interoperability requirements.
- A document revision that captures changes to protocol functionality.

The revision class **Minor** means that the meaning of the technical content was clarified. Minor changes do not affect protocol interoperability or implementation. Examples of minor changes are updates to clarify ambiguity at the sentence, paragraph, or table level.

The revision class **None** means that no new technical changes were introduced. Minor editorial and formatting changes may have been made, but the relevant technical content is identical to the last released version.

The changes made to this document are listed in the following table. For more information, please contact dochelp@microsoft.com.

Section	Description	Revision class
Z Appendix B: Product Behavior	Added Windows Server 2025 to the list of applicable products.	Major

9 Index

A

Abstract data model
 [client](#) 47
 [server](#) 24
[Applicability](#) 9

C

[Capability negotiation](#) 10
[Change tracking](#) 56
Client
 [abstract data model](#) 47
 [initialization](#) 47
 [local events](#) 48
 [message processing](#) 47
 [sequencing rules](#) 47
 [timer events](#) 48
 [timers](#) 47
[Common data types](#) 11

D

Data model - abstract
 [client](#) 47
 [server](#) 24
[Data types](#) 11
 [common - overview](#) 11

E

[error status t](#) 12
Events
 [local - client](#) 48
 [local - server](#) 46
 [timer - client](#) 48
 [timer - server](#) 46
Examples
 [overview](#) 49
 [querying for performance counter data](#) 49
 [querying for performance counter data example](#) 49

F

[Fields - vendor-extensible](#) 10
[Full IDL](#) 52

G

[Glossary](#) 7

I

[IDL](#) 52
[Implementer - security considerations](#) 51
[Implementers - security considerations](#) 51
[Index of security parameters](#) 51
[Informative references](#) 9
Initialization
 [client](#) 47
 [server](#) 25

[Introduction](#) 7

L

Local events
 [client](#) 48
 [server](#) 46

M

Message processing
 [client](#) 47
 [server](#) 25
Messages
 [common data types](#) 11
 [data types](#) 11
 [structures](#) 12
 [transport](#) 11
Methods
 [PerflibV2 Interface](#) 26

N

[Normative references](#) 8

O

[Overview \(synopsis\)](#) 9

P

[Parameters - security](#) 51
[Parameters - security index](#) 51
[PERF_COUNTER_DATA structure](#) 22
[PERF_COUNTER_HEADER structure](#) 21
[PERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER structure](#) 20
[PERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO structure](#) 13
[PERF_COUNTERSET_REG_INFO structure](#) 12
[PERF_DATA_HEADER structure](#) 21
[PERF_INSTANCE_HEADER structure](#) 20
[PERF_MULTI_COUNTERS structure](#) 22
[PERF_MULTI_INSTANCES structure](#) 22
[PERF_STRING_BUFFER_HEADER structure](#) 19
[PERF_STRING_COUNTER_HEADER structure](#) 19
[PerflibV2 Interface method](#) 26
[PerflibV2CloseQueryHandle method](#) 46
[PerflibV2EnumerateCounterSet method](#) 26
[PerflibV2EnumerateCounterSetInstances method](#) 33
[PerflibV2OpenQueryHandle method](#) 35
[PerflibV2QueryCounterData method](#) 37
[PerflibV2QueryCounterInfo method](#) 35
[PerflibV2QueryCounterSetRegistrationInfo method](#) 27
[PerflibV2ValidateCounters method](#) 44
[PPERF_COUNTER_DATA](#) 22
[PPERF_COUNTER_IDENTIFIER](#) 20
[PPERF_COUNTER_REG_INFO](#) 13
[PPERF_COUNTERSET_REG_INFO](#) 12
[PPERF_DATA_HEADER](#) 21
[PPERF_INSTANCE_HEADER](#) 20
[PPERF_MULTI_COUNTERS](#) 22

[PPERF_MULTI_INSTANCES](#) 22
[PPERF_STRING_BUFFER_HEADER](#) 19
[PPERF_STRING_COUNTER_HEADER](#) 19
[PPERFCOUNTERHEADER](#) 21
[Preconditions](#) 9
[Prerequisites](#) 9
[Product behavior](#) 54
Protocol Details
 [overview](#) 24

Q

[Querying for performance counter data example](#) 49

R

[References](#) 8
 [informative](#) 9
 [normative](#) 8
[Relationship to other protocols](#) 9

S

[Security](#) 51
 [implementer considerations](#) 51
 [parameter index](#) 51
Sequencing rules
 [client](#) 47
 [server](#) 25
Server
 [abstract data model](#) 24
 [initialization](#) 25
 [local events](#) 46
 [message processing](#) 25
 [overview](#) 24
 [PerflibV2 Interface method](#) 26
 [sequencing rules](#) 25
 [timer events](#) 46
 [timers](#) 25
[Standards assignments](#) 10
[Structures](#) 12

T

Timer events
 [client](#) 48
 [server](#) 46
Timers
 [client](#) 47
 [server](#) 25
[Tracking changes](#) 56
[Transport](#) 11
[Transport - message](#) 11

V

[Vendor-extensible fields](#) 10
[Versioning](#) 10